2026 PRELIMS 99% MASTERY · CONSOLIDATED CHAPTER-WISE FACTS

INDIAN ART & CULTURE

भारतीय कला एवं संस्कृति — संपूर्ण उच्च-प्राथमिकता संकलन

Temple Architecture (Nagara/Dravida/Vesara), Classical Dances & Music Gharanas, Rock-cut Caves, Painting Schools, UNESCO Sites & Folk Arts.

UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims 2026 • High-Yield Master Revision Series • 99% Coverage Edition

Indian Art & Culture — Master Chapter Index

Consolidated High-Yield Revision Matrix • All 17 Chapters

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Chapter 01: 00 — Executive Bird's-Eye Master Matrix

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Comprehensive Revision & Active Recall Master Sheet

Exam Focus: UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), UKPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO
Frequency: Daily morning read (15–20 minutes)
Syllabus Areas Covered: The 8 Classical Dances with states, pioneers, and exponents; Classical Languages criteria and all 11 recognized languages; Nagara, Dravida, and Vesara architectural styles with masterpiece temples; All 45 UNESCO Tangible World Heritage Sites and all 16 Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) elements; Fairs and festivals of India, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand; Traditional Indian folk paintings, folk theatres, and puppetry traditions; Martial arts of India; Hindustani classical music gharanas and prominent exponents; Prominent Geographical Indication (GI) tags of Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand.

1. The 8 Classical Dances of India (Recognized by Sangeet Natak Akademi)

DANCE FORM	STATE OF ORIGIN	KEY PIONEERS & REVIVALISTS	NOTABLE EXPONENTS	DISTINCTIVE FEATURES, REPERTOIRE & EXAM KEYWORDS
Bharatanatyam	**Tamil Nadu**	**E. Krishna Iyer**, **Rukmini Devi Arundale** (founder of Kalakshetra Foundation)	Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Alarmel Valli, Mrinalini Sarabhai	Regarded as the **oldest classical dance** of India, originating from ancient temple dancer (*Devadasi*) traditions where it was historically known as *Sadir* or *Dasi Attam*. It symbolizes the element of fire (*Agni*) and features the characteristic half-sitting stance termed **Araimandi**. A complete traditional recital follows the structured sequence: *Alarippu → Jatiswaram → Shabdam → Varnam → Padam → Tillana*. It is performed in the *Ekaharya* format, wherein a single performer assumes and portrays multiple roles.
Kathak	**Uttar Pradesh**	**Lady Leela Sokhey** (Madame Menaka), **Nawab Wajid Ali Shah** (patron of Lucknow Gharana)	**Pt. Birju Maharaj**, Sitara Devi, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj, Damayanti Joshi	The name derives from the ancient aphorism *"Katha Kahe So Kathak Kahave"* (one who recites stories is a Kathak). The dance is characterized by intricate and swift rhythmic footwork (**Tatkar**), dazzling pirouettes (**Chakkars**), expressive gait narratives (*Gat Nikas*), and dynamic rhythmic contests (*Jugalbandi*) with the tabla. Its major gharanas include **Lucknow** (famed for grace, *Bhava*, and subtle mime), **Jaipur** (distinguished by fiery footwork, speed, and *Veer rasa*), **Banaras**, and **Raigarh**.
Kathakali	**Kerala**	**Vallathol Narayana Menon** (founder of Kerala Kalamandalam)	Kalamandalam Gopi, Guru Kunchu Kurup, Raman Kutty Nair	A grand visual dance-drama enacting epic narratives from the Ramayana and Mahabharata. It is celebrated for its elaborate facial makeup (*Chutti*) and ornate towering headgear. Character types are defined by strict symbolic facial colors: **Pacha** (green makeup, depicting divine heroes and noble kings), **Kathi** (knife-shaped red streaks on green with a white nose-knob, representing arrogant royalty and villains), **Thadi** (bearded characters: red/black for evil demons, white for pious figures like Hanuman), and **Minukku** (warm yellow/flesh tone, representing virtuous women and sages).
Kuchipudi	**Andhra Pradesh**	**Siddhendra Yogi** (creator of *Bhamakalapam*)	Yamini Krishnamurthy, Raja & Radha Reddy, Swapnasundari	Named after its village of origin, Kuchelapuram in Krishna district, this form developed as a dance-drama tradition combining spoken dialogue, classical singing, and dance. Its most celebrated virtuoso feature is the **Tarangam**, in which the dancer deftly balances upon the raised rim of a brass plate while carrying a brass water pitcher (*Kundi*) balanced steadily atop the head.
Odissi	**Odisha**	**Kelucharan Mohapatra**, Pankaj Charan Das, Deba Prasad Das	Sonal Mansingh, Sanjukta Panigrahi, Madhavi Mudgal	Deeply rooted in temple rituals, its lineage traces back to female temple dancers (*Maharis*) and juvenile male performers (*Gotipuas*). The performance repertoire is heavily inspired by Jayadeva's devotional masterpiece, the *Gita Govinda*. It is distinguished by two fundamental body postures: the feminine, soft, three-bend deflective stance (**Tribhanga**) and the firm, square, masculine stance (**Chowk**).
Sattriya	**Assam**	**Mahapurusha Srimanta Sankardeva** (15th century)	Bhabananda Barbayan, Jatin Goswami, Ghanakanta Bora	Created as an instrument of the Neo-Vaishnavite Bhakti movement, this sacred dance form was nurtured for over five centuries inside monastic sanctuaries known as **Sattras**. Its musical and theatrical foundation rests upon *Borgeet* (devotional songs) and *Ankiya Nat* (one-act devotional plays). The Sangeet Natak Akademi officially recognized Sattriya as India's 8th classical dance in **November 2000**.

DANCE FORM	STATE OF ORIGIN	KEY PIONEERS & REVIVALISTS	NOTABLE EXPONENTS	DISTINCTIVE FEATURES, REPERTOIRE & EXAM KEYWORDS
Manipuri	**Manipur**	**King Bhagyachandra** (Ningthou Ching-Thang Khomba), **Rabindranath Tagore** (introduced at Santiniketan)	Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri Sisters (Nayna, Suvarna, Darshana, Ranjana), Charu Mathur	Centered upon the immortal, tender love of Radha and Krishna through devotional **Raslila** performances. It is distinguished by soft, undulating, lyrical movements in which the dancer's feet never strike the floor sharply. Female dancers wear an ornate, stiff cylindrical skirt known as the **Potloi** or *Kumin*. Performances are traditionally complemented by the energetic, acrobatic drum dance called **Pung Cholom**.
Mohiniyattam	**Kerala**	**Maharaja Swathi Thirunal** of Travancore, **Vallathol Narayana Menon**	Sunanda Nair, Bharati Shivaji, Kanak Rele, Gopika Varma	Literally meaning the "Dance of the Enchantress", this dance draws mythological inspiration from Lord Vishnu's Mohini incarnation. It is performed strictly as a solo feminine recital embodying pure **Lasya** (delicate, wave-like, swaying body movements resembling palm fronds). Performers are clad in a signature pristine off-white handloom saree embellished with a shimmering golden brocade border, known as the **Kasavu saree**.

2. Classical Languages of India (Chronology & Criteria)

A. Chronological Order of Recognition

1. **Tamil** (Declared in **2004**) — Conferred status as India's first Classical Language.
2. **Sanskrit** (Declared in **2005**).
3. **Telugu** (Declared in **2008**).
4. **Kannada** (Declared in **2008**).
5. **Malayalam** (Declared in **2013**).
6. **Odia** (Declared in **2014**).
7. **Marathi** (Approved by the Union Cabinet on **3 October 2024**).
8. **Pali** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
9. **Prakrit** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
10. **Assamese** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).
11. **Bengali** (Approved on **3 October 2024**).

(India officially recognizes 11 Classical Languages following the landmark Union Cabinet decision of October 2024.)

B. Eligibility Criteria (Ministry of Culture)

To qualify for status as a Classical Language, a language must satisfy the following four criteria formulated by the Ministry of Culture: - **High Antiquity:** Recorded history and early literary texts spanning a historical antiquity of **1500 to 2000 years**. - **Valuable Heritage:** A treasured corpus of ancient literature and texts cherished as invaluable heritage by generations of speakers. - **Original Literary Tradition:** A literary heritage that is demonstrably authentic and original, not borrowed from another speech community. - **Linguistic Distinctiveness:** A distinct divergence between the classical language and its modern forms or vernacular offshoots, acknowledging potential historical discontinuity across later evolutionary stages.

3. Temple Architecture Styles & Architectural Anatomy

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│                  NAGARA vs DRAVIDA ARCHITECTURE              │
├──────────────────────────────────┬───────────────────────────┤
│ NAGARA (North Indian Style)      │ DRAVIDA (South Indian Style)  │
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• Curvilinear tower: Shikhara	• Stepped-pyramidal tower: Vimana
• Crowning Amalaka & Kalasha	• Crowning octagonal/dome Stupika
• Built on a raised plinth: Jagati	• Enclosed by elaborate boundary wall
• Monumental gateways absent	• Towering ornamental gates: Gopuram
• Temple water tanks not mandatory	• Temple water tank (Kalyani) inside
• Sub-types: Rekha-Deula, Phamsana	• Multi-pillared assembly Mandapas

A. Core Architectural Vocabulary

- **Garbhagriha (Sanctum Sanctorum):** The innermost, unadorned sacred chamber housing the principal deity, designed to focus divine energy.
- **Mandapa:** A pillared hall situated in front of the sanctum, serving as a gathering space for devotees during rituals.
- **Antarala (Vestibule):** An intermediate foyer or transit vestibule connecting the Garbhagriha with the main Mandapa.
- **Shikhara (North) / Vimana (South):** The monumental mountain-like spire rising skyward directly over the Garbhagriha.
- **Amalaka:** A large, fluted circular stone disc resembling a myrobalan fruit, installed at the apex of a Nagara Shikhara.
- **Kalasha:** A pot- or pitcher-shaped decorative finial placed directly atop the Amalaka as the highest point of the temple.
- **Gopuram:** A towering, monumental gateway providing entrance through the perimeter walls of South Indian Dravidian temple complexes.
- **Panchayatana Style:** An architectural layout where the main central shrine is symmetrically flanked by **four smaller subsidiary shrines** at the corners (prominent examples include the Dashavatara Temple at Deogarh, and the Kandariya Mahadeva and Lakshmana temples at Khajuraho).

B. Masterpiece Temples, Dynasties & Architectural Highlights

TEMPLE NAME	LOCATION	BUILDER DYNASTY & RULER	ARCHITECTURAL STYLE & PRIMARY EXAM SIGNIFICANCE
Kailasa Temple (Cave 16)	Ellora (Maharashtra)	**Krishna I** (Rashtrakuta Dynasty, 8th century CE)	Celebrated as the **world's largest monolithic rock-cut monument**, excavated vertically from top to bottom out of a single volcanic basalt cliff face.
Shore Temple	Mamallapuram (Tamil Nadu)	**Narasimhavarman II Rajasimha** (Pallava Dynasty)	One of the earliest free-standing structural stone temples in Southern India, built on the edge of the Bay of Bengal; designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site.
Brihadeshwara (Rajarajeshwara)	Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu)	**Rajaraja I Chola** (consecrated in 1010 CE)	Represents the zenith of Dravida architecture, crowned by a massive 66-metre pyramidal Vimana and an 80-tonne monolithic granite Stupika; renowned for its shadow engineering.
Gangaikonda Cholapuram	Ariyalur (Tamil Nadu)	**Rajendra I Chola** (1035 CE)	Commissioned to commemorate Rajendra I's victorious military campaign to the holy River Ganga; features a graceful, concave-curving Vimana profile.
Sun Temple	Konark (Odisha)	**Narasimhadeva I** (Eastern Ganga Dynasty, 13th century CE)	Designed in the form of an immense stone chariot dedicated to the Sun God Surya, complete with 24 carved stone wheels and 7 galloping horses; historically termed the **"Black Pagoda"**.
Jagannath Temple	Puri (Odisha)	**Anantavarman Chodaganga** (Eastern Ganga Dynasty)	A quintessential monument of the Kalinga Nagara style (Rekha-Deula); celebrated for the world-famous Ratha Yatra and historically known as the **"White Pagoda"**.
Lingaraja Temple	Bhubaneswar (Odisha)	Somavamshi Dynasty (King Yayati I)	Regarded as the most complete and magnificent specimen of Kalinga architecture, showcasing all four classic halls: Deula, Jagamohana, Natamandapa, and Bhogamandapa.
Sun Temple	Modhera (Gujarat)	**Bhima I** (Solanki / Chaulukya Dynasty, 1026 CE)	Built in the ornate Maru-Gurjara style; renowned for its grand stepped water tank (**Surya Kund**) adorned with 108 miniature shrines along its terraces.
Kandariya Mahadeva Temple	Khajuraho (Madhya Pradesh)	**Dhangadeva / Vidyadhara** (Chandela Dynasty, 10th–11th century CE)	The largest and most elaborate Hindu temple at Khajuraho; erected on a Panchayatana plan with a soaring Shikhara accompanied by 84 subsidiary spires (*Urushringas*).
Dilwara Jain Temples	Mount Abu (Rajasthan)	**Vimal Shah** (Vimal Vasahi, 1031 CE) & **Tejpala / Vastupala** (Luna Vasahi, 1230 CE)	Outstanding examples of Solanki temple craft, internationally famous for their luminous, translucent white marble ceiling carvings and filigree stonework.
Hoysaleswara Temple	Halebidu (Karnataka)	King Vishnuvardhana (Hoysala Dynasty)	Carved from soft chloritic schist (soapstone) on a stellate (star-shaped) plinth, covered in intricate, continuous narrative friezes; inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2023.
Chennakeshava Temple	Belur (Karnataka)	King Vishnuvardhana (Hoysala Dynasty, 1117 CE)	Built to commemorate Hoysala military triumphs; celebrated for its star-shaped sanctum and masterfully sculpted *Madanika* bracket figures; inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site in 2023.
Dashavatara Temple	Deogarh (Lalitpur district, UP)	Gupta Period (6th century CE)	Stands as the **earliest surviving Panchayatana stone temple in Northern India**, famous for its classical relief depiction of Sheshashayi Vishnu reclining on the serpent Shesha.
Bhitargaon Temple	Kanpur district (UP)	Gupta Period (5th century CE; Gupta imperial span c. 320–550 CE)	Recognized as the **oldest surviving terracotta and brick temple** in India featuring a genuine radiating structural arch.

Dynastic Spans for Key Temple Builders: Gupta Empire (c. 320–550 CE: Deogarh, Bhitargaon); Imperial Pallavas (c. 575–897 CE: Shore Temple under Rajasimha); Rashtrakutas (c. 753–973 CE: Kailasa Temple under Krishna I); Imperial Cholas (c. 850–1279 CE: Rajaraja I in 1010 CE, Rajendra I in 1035 CE); Chandelas of Jejakabhukti (c. 9th–13th century CE: Khajuraho); Eastern Gangas (c. 11th–15th century CE: Konark, Puri); Hoysalas (c. 11th–14th century CE: Belur in 1117 CE, Halebidu); Solankis / Chaulukyas of Gujarat (c. 10th–13th century CE: Modhera in 1026 CE).

4. Fairs and Festivals of India, Uttar Pradesh & Uttarakhand

A. Major National Cultural Festivals

- **Hornbill Festival (Nagaland):** Held annually from 1 to 10 December at the Naga Heritage Village in Kisama; acclaimed as the "Festival of Festivals", it showcases the collective traditions of all 16 recognized Naga tribes.
- **Bihu (Assam):** Celebrated across three distinct agricultural cycles: *Rongali (Bohag) Bihu* in spring (April) marking the Assamese New Year, *Kongali (Kati) Bihu* in autumn marking crop protection, and *Bhogali (Magh) Bihu* in winter marking the post-harvest feast.
- **Chapchar Kut (Mizoram):** Celebrated with great joy in spring after the completion of jhum (slash-and-burn) clearing operations; famously features the traditional *Cheraw* bamboo dance.
- **Losar (Ladakh, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh):** The traditional Buddhist and Tibetan New Year festival, observed with monastic mask dances (*Cham*) and elaborate symbolic offerings.
- **Pushkar Fair (Ajmer, Rajasthan):** One of the world's largest livestock and camel trading fairs, organized during Kartik Purnima along the holy banks of Lake Pushkar.
- **Thrissur Pooram (Kerala):** Staged at the Vadakkunnathan Temple in Thrissur; renowned for competitive temple displays featuring caparisoned elephants, dynamic parasol exchanges (*Kudamattam*), and majestic traditional percussion ensembles (*Panchavadyam*).
- **Wangala Festival (Garo Hills, Meghalaya):** Known as the "100 Drum Festival", this post-harvest celebration is observed by the Garo tribe in honor of Saljong, the Sun God of fertility.

B. Uttar Pradesh Fairs & Festivals (High-Yield State Core)

- **Kumbh Mela & Magh Mela (Prayagraj):** Organized at the sacred Triveni Sangam (confluence of the Ganga, Yamuna, and mythical Saraswati); the Maha Kumbh takes place every 12 years, with the annual Magh Mela held during the Hindu month of Magha.
- **Bateshwar Fair (Bateshwar, Agra):** A renowned historic cattle and livestock fair hosted along the Yamuna riverbank, famous for its picturesque riverside cluster of 101 Shiva temples.
- **Nauchandi Mela (Meerut):** A celebrated symbol of communal fraternity held after Holi, where pilgrims pay homage concurrently to the shrine of Nav Chandi Devi and the dargah of Sufi saint Hazrat Bale Miyan.
- **Shakumbhari Devi Mela (Saharanpur):** Organized twice every year during the auspicious Chaitra and Ashwin Navratris at the historic Shakumbhari Devi Peeth in the Shivalik foothills.
- **Devi Patan Mela (Tulsipur, Balrampur):** A major annual fair held at the sacred Devi Patan Shaktipeeth, deeply revered across the Indo-Nepal Terai region.
- **Dadri Mela (Ballia):** Regarded as India's second-largest cattle fair, historically established and named in commemoration of the revered sage Dardar Muni.
- **Govardhan Parikrama & Lathmar Holi (Mathura, Barsana & Nandgaon):** Centuries-old Braj traditions featuring circumambulation of the sacred Govardhan Hill and the joyous playful stick-and-shield Holi celebrations between the women of Barsana and the men of Nandgaon.
- **Taj Mahotsav (Agra):** A vibrant 10-day cultural extravaganza organized each February at Shilpgram near the Taj Mahal, highlighting Mughal crafts, culinary arts, and folk performances.
- **Sulh-i-Kul Festival (Agra):** Inspired by Emperor Akbar's imperial principle of universal peace and religious tolerance (*Sulh-i-Kul*), this festival serves as a cornerstone of interfaith unity.

C. Uttarakhand Fairs & Festivals (UKPCS Priority)

- **Nanda Devi Raj Jat (Chamoli, Uttarakhand):** Organized **once every 12 years**, this epic 280-kilometre barefoot pilgrimage spans from Nauti village to the sacred lake of Homkund at the base of Mount Trishul, led by a sacred four-horned ram (**Chasingha Khadu**).
- **Ramman (Saloor-Dungra village, Joshimath, Chamoli):** A ritualistic religious festival and folk theatre dedicated to the tutelary deity **Bhumiyal Devta**; features masked dances utilizing traditional painted wooden masks and has been inscribed on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list.
- **Bagwal Mela / Stone-Throwing Fair (Devidhura, Champawat):** Celebrated annually on Raksha Bandhan at the Maa Varahi Devi Temple, where warriors of four local clans (*Khams*) traditionally engage in stone-hurling ritual combat.
- **Purnagiri Mela (Tanakpur, Champawat):** Attracts hundreds of thousands of devotees during Chaitra Navratri to the Purnagiri Shaktipeeth perched above the Sharda (Kali) River.
- **Uttarayani Mela (Bageshwar):** Celebrated on Makar Sankranti at the holy confluence of the Saryu and Gomati rivers; carries immense modern historical importance as the site where registers of the oppressive Coolie-Begar forced labor system were dumped into the river in 1921.
- **Jaiti Mela (Almora):** A traditional cultural fair of the Kumaon region, featuring spirited performances of the circular *Jhora* dance and traditional folk ballads.

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5. UNESCO Tangible World Heritage Sites in India (45 Total Sites)

India currently possesses 45 inscribed UNESCO World Heritage Sites following the historic inscription of Sarnath in July 2026.

- **The Sole Mixed Heritage Site: Khangchendzonga National Park** (Sikkim, inscribed in 2016 for combined natural and cultural criteria).
- **Latest Landmark Inscriptions:**
- **#45: Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath (Uttar Pradesh)** — Inscribed in **July 2026** at the 48th World Heritage Committee session in Busan. This serial cultural site encompasses the monumental **Chaukhandi Stupa** together with the excavated core remains including the Dhamek Stupa and Ashokan pillar sanctuary. It represents **Uttar Pradesh's 4th cultural World Heritage Site**.
- **#44: Maratha Military Landscapes of India** (Inscribed in **2025**; covers 12 historic fortifications: 11 in Maharashtra and Gingee Fort in Tamil Nadu).
- **#43: Moidams – Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty** (Charaideo district, Assam, inscribed in **2024**).
- **#42: Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas** (Karnataka — Belur, Halebidu, and Somnathpura, inscribed in **2023**).
- **#41: Santiniketan** (Birbhum district, West Bengal, inscribed in **2023**).
- **#40: Dholavira: A Harappan City** (Kutch district, Gujarat, inscribed in **2021**).
- **#39: Kakatiya Rudreshwara / Ramappa Temple** (Palampet, Mulugu district, Telangana, inscribed in **2021**).
- **Uttar Pradesh Tangible Cultural World Heritage Sites (4 Sites):** 1. **Taj Mahal** (Agra — inscribed in 1983) 2. **Agra Fort** (Agra — inscribed in 1983) 3. **Fatehpur Sikri** (Agra — inscribed in 1986) 4. **Ancient Buddhist Site of Sarnath** (Varanasi district — inscribed in **2026**)
- **Uttarakhand Tangible Natural World Heritage Site (1 Serial Property):**
- **Nanda Devi and Valley of Flowers National Parks** (Chamoli district, inscribed in 1988, expanded in 2005).

> **Important Distinction:** In examination questions, do not quote obsolete counts of 42 or 43 sites, nor limit Uttar Pradesh to only 3 tangible sites following the 2026 inscription of Sarnath. Furthermore, note that the inclusion of **Deepavali** (December 2025) belongs to UNESCO's **Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH)** list, which is entirely distinct from physical World Heritage monuments.

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6. Important Geographical Indications (GI Tags) of UP & UK

STATE	PRODUCT NAME & CRAFT	CATEGORY	DISTINCTIVE ORIGIN DISTRICT & SIGNIFICANCE
Uttar Pradesh	**Banaras Brocades and Sarees**	Handicraft	Varanasi; renowned globally for rich gold and silver (*Zari*) brocade handloom weaving.
	Bhadohi Handmade Carpet	Handicraft	Bhadohi (Mirzapur-Bhadohi carpet manufacturing belt); premier woollen hand-knotted carpets.
	Lucknow Chikan Craft	Handicraft	Lucknow; centuries-old delicate white-on-white hand embroidery patronized by Awadh Nawabs.
	Kannauj Perfume (Attar)	Manufactured	Kannauj; acclaimed as the "Perfume Capital of India", distilling natural floral attar in copper stills.
	Moradabad Metal Craft	Handicraft	Moradabad; widely celebrated as *Peetal Nagari* (Brass City) for ornate engraved brassware.
	Firozabad Glassware	Handicraft	Firozabad; known as *Suhag Nagari*, the historic hub of India's glass bangle and glassware industry.
	Aligarh Locks	Manufactured	Aligarh; traditionally designated as *Tala Nagari* (City of Locks) for precision brass and iron locks.
	Gorakhpur Terracotta	Handicraft	Gorakhpur; traditional reddish clay craftsmanship producing distinctive elephant and horse figurines.
	Kalanamak Rice	Agriculture	Siddhartha Nagar and surrounding Terai districts; aromatic black-husked rice associated with Lord Buddha.
	Mahoba Gaura Patthar Hastashilp	Handicraft	Mahoba (Bundelkhand); delicate carving in soft, radiant white pyrophyllite stone.
Uttarakhand	**Berinag Tea**	Agriculture	Pithoragarh district; exquisite, aromatic orthodox Himalayan tea made from wild and cultivated bush leaves.
	Almora Bal Mithai	Food Stuff	Almora; iconic roasted fudge-like sweet made from condensed milk (*khoya*), coated with white sugar globules.
	Uttarakhand Bhotia Dan	Handicraft	Pithoragarh and Chamoli; dense, hand-knotted traditional woollen floor rugs woven by Bhotia tribal women.
	Munsyari White Rajma	Agriculture	Munsyari (Pithoragarh); high-altitude organic kidney beans prized for delicate texture and swift cooking.
	Uttarakhand Ringal Craft	Handicraft	Chamoli and Garhwal hills; flexible Himalayan dwarf bamboo (*Ringal*) woven into baskets, mats, and wares.
	Uttarakhand Aipan Art	Handicraft	Kumaon region; sacred ritual geometric floor and wall art painted with white rice paste over red ochre.
	Uttarakhand Bichhu Buti (Nettle Fabric)	Textile	Chamoli district; eco-friendly natural fiber extracted from wild Himalayan stinging nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*).
	Jhangora & Manduwa	Agriculture	Mountain districts of Uttarakhand; highly nutritious traditional hill millets (Barnyard Millet and Finger Millet).

7. Folk Paintings of India — State-Wise Master Guide

TRADITIONAL PAINTING FORM	STATE / REGION	KEY FEATURES, MEDIA & CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE
Sanjhi	**Uttar Pradesh** (Mathura–Vrindavan / Braj)	An exquisite traditional stencilled **paper-cutting art** practiced along the Yamuna ghats of Mathura and Vrindavan. Traditionally fashioned during Krishna festivals and Pitru Paksha; recognized with an official GI tag.
Aipan	**Uttarakhand** (Kumaon)	A sacred ritual floor and wall art created using white rice-flour paste (*Biswar*) upon an ochre-red background (*Geru*), featuring complex geometric and floral protective motifs. Holds a GI tag.
Madhubani (Mithila Painting)	**Bihar** (Mithila region)	Practiced traditionally by women using natural pigments and brushes made of twigs and nibs; characterized by vivid double-line borders and stylized motifs of deities, nature, and the wedding chamber (*Kohbar*). Holds a GI tag.
Warli	**Maharashtra** (Thane / Palghar)	An ancient tribal art executed on mud-and-cowdung plastered walls using white pigment made of rice paste and water, depicting community dancing, harvesting, and reverence for the mother goddess *Palaghata*.
Pattachitra	**Odisha** (also practiced in West Bengal)	A traditional scroll painting executed on treated cloth (*Patta*) or dried palm leaves using natural mineral colors, illustrating episodes from the life of Lord Jagannath, Krishna, and Vaishnava legends.
Phad	**Rajasthan** (Bhilwara / Shahpura)	Immense narrative cloth scroll paintings depicting the heroic exploits of folk deities such as Pabuji and Devnarayan, traditionally recited and sung by traveling priest-bards (*Bhopas*).
Gond	**Madhya Pradesh** (Mandla / Dindori)	Celebrated tribal art of the Gond community, characterized by rich textures composed of fine dots, dashes, and rhythmic lines, depicting flora, fauna, and their supreme forest divinity *Bada Dev*.
Kalamkari	**Andhra Pradesh**	Traditional hand-painted and block-printed textile art using natural vegetable dyes and a sharpened bamboo reed (*kalam*). Maintained through two prominent traditions: **Srikalahasti** (freehand temple hangings depicting epics) and **Machilipatnam** (block-printed trade designs).
Pithora	**Gujarat & Madhya Pradesh** (Rathwa & Bhil tribes)	Sacred ritual wall paintings executed inside tribal homes to invoke prosperity and fulfill vows, centered on the consecrated depiction of horses honoring the deity *Pithora Baba*.
Kalighat	**West Bengal** (Kolkata)	A 19th-century urban folk painting style that developed around the Kalighat Kali Temple, renowned for sweeping brush lines and watercolor washes depicting Hindu divinities and satirical caricatures of the colonial elite.
Phulkari	**Punjab**	Traditional folk floral embroidery executed on coarse dyed cotton cloth (*khaddar*) using vibrant untwisted silk threads (*pat*), traditionally gifted during weddings.
Mandana	**Rajasthan & Malwa**	Auspicious geometric floor and wall designs drawn with white chalk (*khadiya*) against red clay plaster to welcome deities and mark domestic festivals.

Key Exam Distinction: Do not confuse **Sanjhi** (indigenous to the Braj region of Uttar Pradesh), **Aipan** (traditional to Kumaon in Uttarakhand), and **Madhubani** (native to Bihar). Each holds a distinct geographical and cultural identity.

8. All 16 UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) Elements of India

Inscribed on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (Ministry of Culture & UNESCO):

#	YEAR INSCRIBED	INTANGIBLE CULTURAL HERITAGE ELEMENT	REGION / COMMUNITY	PRIMARY RITUAL & CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE
1	**2008**	**Koodiyattam (Kutiyattam)**	**Kerala**	India's oldest living Sanskrit temple theatre tradition, performed in consecrated theatre halls called *Koothambalams* with the accompaniment of copper *Mizhavu* drums.
2	**2008**	**Ramlila**	**Uttar Pradesh & North India**	The traditional dramatic enactment of the Ramayana during Dussehra, epitomized by the world-famous month-long open-air Ramnagar Ramlila of Varanasi supported by the Kashi Naresh.
3	**2008**	**Tradition of Vedic Chanting**	Pan-India	The uninterrupted oral recitation of sacred Vedic hymns handed down over millennia through sophisticated mnemonic recitation techniques such as *Jatapatha* and *Ghanapatha*.
4	**2009**	**Ramman**	**Saloor-Dungra village, Chamoli (Uttarakhand)**	A ritual festival and sacred masked theatre held in honor of the tutelary deity **Bhumiyal Devta**, where villagers perform epic episodes wearing traditional wooden masks.
5	**2010**	**Chhau Dance**	**Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha**	A semi-classical martial dance tradition that encompasses three distinct regional streams: **Seraikella** (Jharkhand, masked), **Purulia** (West Bengal, large theatrical masks), and **Mayurbhanj** (Odisha, performed without masks).
6	**2010**	**Kalbelia Folk Songs and Dances**	**Rajasthan**	A sensuous, serpent-like folk dance performed by women of the nomadic Kalbelia snake-charmer community, rhythmically driven by the *Poongi* (been) and *Dhaf*.
7	**2010**	**Mudiyettu**	**Kerala**	A sacred ritual dance-drama performed in Kali temples, dramatizing the mythological battle between the goddess Kali and the demon Darika; preceded by elaborate floor paintings called *Kalam*.
8	**2012**	**Buddhist Chanting of Ladakh**	**Ladakh (Trans-Himalaya)**	The solemn rhythmic chanting of sacred Buddhist texts and philosophical teachings by Mahayana monks (Lamas) of the Gelukpa, Drukpa, and Kagyu monastic lineages.
9	**2013**	**Sankirtana**	**Manipur**	A sacred ritual performance encompassing devotional singing, drumming (*Pung*), and graceful dance, performed by Meitei Vaishnavites to mark life-cycle ceremonies and religious festivals.
10	**2014**	**Traditional Brass and Copper Craft of Utensil Making**	**Jandiala Guru, Amritsar (Punjab)**	The artisanal metal-working technique of hammering heated brass and copper plates into household vessels, practiced traditionally by the hereditary **Thathera** community.
11	**2016**	**Yoga**	Pan-India (Global)	The ancient Indian physical, mental, and spiritual discipline founded upon Patanjali's Ashtanga Yoga; commemorated internationally each year on **21 June**.
12	**2016**	**Nawrouz (Nowruz)**	Parsi & Kashmiri communities	The ancient Persian New Year festival celebrated annually on the vernal equinox (**21 March**), signifying renewal, peace, and the rebirth of nature.
13	**2017**	**Kumbh Mela**	**Prayagraj (UP), Haridwar (UK), Ujjain (MP), Nashik (Maharashtra)**	The largest peaceful religious gathering of pilgrims on Earth, rotating across four sacred river sanctuaries (Ganga, Godavari, and Kshipra) over twelve-year cycles.
14	**2021**	**Durga Puja in Kolkata**	**Kolkata (West Bengal)**	A monumental 10-day autumn festival celebrating the triumph of Goddess Durga over Mahishasura, renowned for extraordinary public art installations, community pandals, and syncretic celebrations.

#	YEAR INSCRIBED	INTANGIBLE CULTURAL HERITAGE ELEMENT	REGION / COMMUNITY	PRIMARY RITUAL & CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE
15	**2023**	**Garba of Gujarat**	**Gujarat**	A devotional, circular community dance performed during the nine nights of Navratri around a perforated earthen lamp (*Garbha Deep*) or an image of Goddess Amba.
16	**2025 (Dec)**	**Deepavali (Festival of Lights)**	Pan-India	Inscribed at the 20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee in December 2025 as India's 16th ICH element, honoring the universal celebration of light over darkness and wisdom over ignorance.

9. Traditional Folk Theatres & Puppetry of India

A. Major Folk Theatres

FOLK THEATRE FORM	STATE / REGION	KEY FEATURES, DRAMATURGY & MUSICAL ACCOMPANIMENT
Nautanki	**Uttar Pradesh**	Highly popular operatic folk musical theatre of Northern India; evolved two renowned styles: **Hathras** (emphasizing classical singing) and **Kanpur** (noted for crisp theatrical dialogue). Plays feature verses in *Doha, Chaubola*, and *Chhand* meters accompanied by the thunderous **Nakkara** (kettledrum).
Bhand Pather	**Jammu & Kashmir**	Traditional satirical folk theatre practiced by rural farming communities; blends witty social criticism, parodies, and slapstick comedy with music played on the *Surnai* (shehnai-like reed) and *Dhol*.
Swang / Saang	**Haryana & Western UP**	Dialogue-driven musical folk drama written in rhymed verse; pioneered by celebrated playwrights such as Pt. Deep Chand and Kishan Lal Bhat; staged on open platforms surrounded by spectators.
Rasleela & Ramlila	**Uttar Pradesh** (Mathura–Vrindavan & Ayodhya / Varanasi)	Devotional dance-dramas dramatizing the divine childhood pastimes of Lord Krishna in Braj and the heroic life journey of Lord Rama across Awadh and Varanasi.
Bhavai	**Gujarat & Rajasthan**	Fast-paced socio-religious folk theatre initiated by the 14th-century poet Asaita Thakar; features male actors balancing up to eight earthen pots on their heads while playing the long brass trumpet known as the **Bhungal**.
Jatra	**West Bengal & Odisha**	Open-air musical melodrama that emerged during the Bhakti movement under Chaitanya Mahaprabhu; characterized by grand musical prologues, impassioned dialogues, and high dramatic intensity.
Yakshagana	**Karnataka** (Coastal)	Spectacular traditional theatre based on episodes from the Hindu epics; distinguished by elaborate costumes, towering decorated headdresses (**Muguta**), vivid facial cosmetics, and high athletic leaps.
Therukoothu	**Tamil Nadu**	Traditional rural street theatre performed in village squares, historically centered on the annual festival worship of Draupadi Amman.
Koodiyattam	**Kerala**	Classical Sanskrit temple drama recognized as a UNESCO ICH masterpiece; features stylized hand gestures (*Mudras*) and highly sophisticated eye movements accompanied by *Mizhavu* drums.
Ankiya Nat / Bhaona	**Assam**	One-act Vaishnavite devotional plays created by **Srimanta Sankardeva**; composed in the literary language *Brajavali* and traditionally staged in monastic assembly halls (**Namghars**).
Tamasha	**Maharashtra**	Energetic, fast-paced secular folk theatre that evolved in military camps; combines satirical comedy, witty banter, and lively *Lavani* dance accompanied by the *Dholki*.
Dashavatar	**Konkan / Goa / Maharashtra**	Traditional temple folk theatre depicting the ten divine incarnations of Lord Vishnu, widely performed during local harvest festivities.

B. Traditional Indian Puppetry (Four Master Traditions)

PUPPETRY FORM	TRADITIONAL NAME	STATE OF ORIGIN	KEY CONSTRUCTION & MANIPULATION FEATURES
String Puppets	**Kathputli**	**Rajasthan**	Carved from a single block of mango wood and dressed in vibrant medieval Rajasthani garments; manipulated with strings, while the puppeteer produces sharp whistling voices using a reed whistle called a *Boli*.
	Kundhei	**Odisha**	Made of lightweight wood with long flowing skirts and no articulated legs; movements are closely attuned to the rhythms of Odissi music.
	Gombeyatta	**Karnataka**	Highly stylized wooden puppets modeled directly upon the elaborate costumes, headdresses, and characters of **Yakshagana** theatre.
	Bommalattam	**Tamil Nadu**	Combines mechanisms of **both rod and string puppetry**; represents the largest, heaviest, and most mechanically complex puppets in India, operated via a cloth ring worn on the puppeteer's head.
Shadow Puppets	**Tholu Bommalata**	**Andhra Pradesh**	Translucent leather puppets painted in glowing vegetable colors on both sides; projected against a backlit white cloth screen.
	Togalu Gombeyatta	**Karnataka**	Small, delicate leather shadow figures depicting epic scenes, operated behind an illuminated white screen.
	Ravanachhaya	**Odisha**	Made from opaque deerskin; **casts purely black-and-white shadows** on the screen without color projections and has no articulated joints, producing dramatic silhouetted forms.
Glove Puppets	**Pavakoothu**	**Kerala**	Worn directly over the puppeteer’s hand; intricately modeled with carved wooden heads and painted costumes inspired directly by **Kathakali** makeup and crowns.
Rod Puppets	**Putul Nach**	**West Bengal**	Heavy wooden dolls sculpted with shoulder joints; manipulated from beneath the stage by puppeteers holding sturdy control rods.
	Yampuri	**Bihar**	Carved entirely from single pieces of wood without joints; specifically dramatizes moral tales set in the court of Yama, the God of Death.

10. Martial Arts of India

MARTIAL ART FORM	STATE OF ORIGIN	KEY WEAPONS, PRINCIPLES & DISTINCTIVE FEATURES
Kalaripayattu	**Kerala**	Celebrated as the **oldest living martial art in the world** (mythologically attributed to Sage Parashurama); practiced within a sacred subterranean earthen arena (*Kalari*). Employs strikes, grappling, and traditional weapons including the deadly flexible whip-sword (**Urumi**), staff, and buckler.
Silambam	**Tamil Nadu**	An ancient staff-fencing martial art referenced in Sangam literature such as the *Silappadikaram*; utilizes a 1.68-metre rapid-spinning **bamboo staff** (*Silambam*) to deflect attacks and strike vulnerable targets.
Thang-Ta & Sarit Sarak	**Manipur**	The traditional combat system of Meitei warriors; **Thang-Ta** emphasizes armed warfare (**Thang** = sword, **Ta** = spear), while **Sarit Sarak** comprises unarmed hand-to-hand combat and evasion.
Gatka	**Punjab**	Traditional Sikh martial art codified under the patronage of the sixth Sikh Guru, **Guru Hargobind Ji**; practitioners utilize wooden training swords (*Gatka*) and leather target shields, prominently demonstrated during the Hola Mohalla festival.
Pari-Khanda	**Bihar**	Created historically by Rajput warriors; utilizes the shield (**Pari**) and two-edged sword (**Khanda**); its footwork patterns and athletic steps form the foundational physical vocabulary of **Chhau dance**.
Thoda	**Himachal Pradesh**	A traditional martial sport rooted in **archery** that traces its lineage to the Mahabharata; practiced during Baisakhi in the Kullu and Shimla hills, where competing archers aim blunt arrows strictly at their opponents' legs below the knees.
Mallakhamb	**Madhya Pradesh & Maharashtra**	An extraordinary traditional gymnastic martial discipline in which athletes perform dynamic aerial yoga postures and acrobatic maneuvers on a vertical polished teak pole or a hanging cotton rope; declared the **State Sport of Madhya Pradesh**.
Musti-Yuddha	**Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)**	Ancient traditional unarmed Indian pugilism and bare-knuckle boxing utilizing punches, elbow strikes, and grappling maneuvers.
Mardani Khel	**Maharashtra** (Kolhapur)	A historic Maratha armed martial art emphasizing agility, swordplay with the flexible gauntlet-sword (**Patta**), and defense using the bamboo staff (*Kathi*).
Kuttu Varisai	**Tamil Nadu**	Traditional Dravidian unarmed martial art focusing on rapid footwork, devastating animal-style strikes, and knowledge of vital pressure points (**Varma Kalai**).

11. Hindustani Classical Music Gharanas & Leading Exponents

GHARANA	FOUNDERS & HISTORICAL PIONEERS	KEY STYLISTIC CHARACTERISTICS & AESTHETICS	RENOWNED MAESTROS & LEGENDARY EXPONENTS
Gwalior Gharana	**Nathan Pir Bakhsh**, **Hassu Khan**, **Haddu Khan**	Acknowledged as the **oldest and foundational Khayal gharana**; characterized by an unadorned, noble, open-throated singing style (*Aakaar*), balanced exposition of the raga, and systematic note expansion.	Vishnu Digambar Paluskar, Pt. Omkarnath Thakur, D.V. Paluskar, Malini Rajurkar, Neela Bhagwat
Agra Gharana	**Haji Sujan Khan**, **Khuda Bakhsh**; revitalized by **Ustad Faiyaz Khan**	Famously known as the **"Rangeela Gharana"**; marked by a robust, deep, resonant voice culture that masterfully infuses classical Khayal with ancient Dhrupad-Dhamar *Nom-Tom* alap elements.	Ustad Faiyaz Khan, Vilayat Hussain Khan, Shrikrishna Narayan Ratanjankar, Khadim Hussain Khan
Kirana Gharana	**Ustad Abdul Karim Khan**, **Ustad Abdul Wahid Khan** (originating from Kirana, Shamli district, UP)	Distinguished by deep emotional resonance, supreme tonal purity (*Sur*), and leisurely, contemplative note-by-note melodic evolution (**Vilambit Khayal**).	**Pt. Bhimsen Joshi**, Gangubai Hangal, Sawai Gandharva, Prabha Atre, Hirabai Barodekar
Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana	**Ustad Alladiya Khan**	Celebrated for complex, rare, and compound ragas (*Jod Ragas*); distinguished by intricate, spiral rhythmic phrasing (*Taans*) executed in an offbeat, asymmetrical swing across challenging talas.	**Kishori Amonkar**, Kesarbai Kerkar, Mogubai Kurdikar, Mallikarjun Mansur, Shruti Sadolikar
Patiala Gharana	**Ustad Fateh Ali Khan** and **Ustad Ali Bakhsh Khan** ("Alia-Fattu")	Known for dynamic, lightning-fast cascade passages (*Taans*), expressive emotional embellishments, and seamless mastery over both classical Khayal and romantic semiclassical **Thumri**.	**Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan**, Begum Akhtar, Parveen Sultana, Jagjit Singh, Ajoy Chakrabarty
Banaras Gharana (Vocal & Instrumental)	**Pt. Ram Sahai** (Tabla pioneer), **Thakur Prasad** (Kathak pioneer)	Celebrated worldwide for its unparalleled mastery over the **Tabla**, **Sarangi**, and **Shehnai**, as well as soul-stirring semiclassical vocal forms including **Thumri, Dadra, Chaiti, and Kajri**.	**Ustad Bismillah Khan** (Shehnai — Bharat Ratna), **Pt. Kishan Maharaj** (Tabla), **Pt. Samta Prasad / Gudai Maharaj** (Tabla), **Girija Devi** (Queen of Thumri), Siddheshwari Devi, Rajan & Sajan Mishra

Chapter 02: Institutions Related to Indian Culture

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Sachin Chaturvedi** assumed charge as Vice-Chancellor of Nalanda University in **May 2025**.
2. **Fort William College** was set up in **1800** by **Lord Wellesley** to train Company officers in Indian languages.
3. **Sanskrit College, Calcutta** opened in **1824. Benares Sanskrit College** was founded by **Jonathan Duncan** in **1791** and must not be confused with the Asiatic Society.
4. **Kangri Gurukul** at Haridwar was founded in **1902** by **Swami Shraddhanand** in the Dayananda / Arya Samaj line.
5. **Nalanda** (नालंदा) mahavihara in Bihar flourished under Pala patronage. **Hiuen Tsang** (ह्वेनसांग) studied there. It was destroyed around **1193** by Bakhtiyar Khilji. The ruins are UNESCO **2016** under the **ASI**.
6. **Taxila (Takshashila)** lay in Gandhara, now in **Pakistan**. It was a multi-teacher city linked with **Panini** (पाणिनि) and **Chanakya** (चाणक्य), and is UNESCO **1980**.
7. **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला) at Bhagalpur was founded by Pala **Dharmapala. Atisha** taught there. It fell around **1203** to Khilji and is **not** a separate World Heritage site.
8. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) (**1952**) covers performing arts. **Sahitya Akademi** and **Lalit Kala Akademi** (ललित कला अकादेमी) both date to **1954** for literature and visual arts.
9. **Sahitya Akademi** awards in **24** languages. **Jnanpith** (ज्ञानपीठ) (**1965**) is a Bharatiya Jnanpith trust prize, not a Sahitya Akademi award.
10. **IGNCA** and the **Ministry of Culture** date to **1985**. **CCRT** began in **1979**. **NGMA** dates to **1954**. The **National School of Drama (NSD)** was founded in **1959** at New Delhi.
11. **Kalakshetra** at Chennai, founded by **Rukmini Devi Arundale**, is the premier Bharatanatyam and arts academy. **INTACH** (**1984**) is an **NGO** for heritage conservation, not a Culture ministry akademi.
12. **ICCR** (Indian Council for Cultural Relations, **1950**) belongs to the **MEA**, not the Culture Ministry.
13. **HRIDAY** (**2015**) includes **Varanasi. PRASAD** is a **Tourism** ministry scheme, not Culture.
14. **Odantapuri** and **Somapura** (Paharpur, Bangladesh) are Pala-age Buddhist centres often paired with Nalanda and Vikramashila; Somapura is UNESCO, not a UP site.
15. **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya (CSMVS)** is Mumbai's former Prince of Wales Museum. Do not place Salar Jung in Delhi or Mumbai.
16. **ICCR** does cultural diplomacy abroad. The seven **ZCCs** do regional folk outreach inside India. Do not swap MEA vs Culture parentage.
17. **Gurukul Kangri Vishwavidyalaya** was founded at Haridwar in **1902** by **Dayananda Saraswati** (Arya Samaj). It taught Vedic and modern subjects. Arya Samaj gurukuls spread in the Gangetic belt including **Uttar Pradesh.
18. **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)** visited in **630–643 CE**. His teacher was **Shilabhadra**. Studies covered logic (**Hetuvidya**), medicine, grammar and Mahayana (plus some Vedas for comparison).
19. **Alexander** encountered the Taxila kingdom in **326 BCE**. Later **Gandhara Greco-Buddhist art developed here.
20. **Rabindra Bhavan**, Mandi House, New Delhi, houses **Sangeet Natak Akademi (1952, performing)**, **Sahitya Akademi (1954, letters)** and **Lalit Kala Akademi (1954, visual)**.
21. **Jnanpith** (first **1965**, Bharatiya Jnanpith **trust**) is a **different** honour. It is not an Akademi prize.
22. **NGMA** is a museum/gallery of modern art. Lalit Kala is an **academy** (awards, scholarships, triennale).
23. **BNA** is theatre training, not painting.
24. **Kathak Sansthan** is Lucknow gharana documentation, not Bharatanatyam.
25. **NCZCC** HQ is **Prayagraj**, not Lucknow — the planted city swap in many match lists.
26. **ICCR** is under **MEA**. The new Nalanda University is also under **MEA**. ASI and the akademis are under **Culture**.

Chapter 03: Religious and Philosophical Traditions

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Maha Kumbh** at Prayagraj ran from **13 January to 26 February 2025**, about **45** days.
2. **Kumbh Mela** (कुंभ मेला) is on the UNESCO Intangible Heritage list from **2017**. It is not a tangible monument.
3. **Nyaya** (न्याय) is logic and epistemology with four pramanas (प्रमाण). **Vaisheshika** (वैशेषिक) is atomism (*paramanu* / परमाणु). This Gautama is **not** the Buddha.
4. **Samkhya** (सांख्य) is dualist Purusha–Prakriti (पुरुष-प्रकृति) with **25** tattvas (तत्त्व) and is classically **nirishvara** (निरीश्वरवाद). **Yoga** (योग) is its practical partner and adds **Ishvara** (ईश्वर).
5. **Ashtanga Yoga** (अष्टांग योग) order is **yama** (यम), **niyama** (नियम), **asana** (आसन), **pranayama** (प्राणायाम), **pratyahara** (प्रत्याहार), **dharana** (धारणा), **dhyana** (ध्यान), **samadhi** (समाधि).
6. **Purva Mimamsa** (पूर्व मीमांसा - Jaimini) treats Vedic **ritual** (कर्मकाण्ड). **Uttara Mimamsa / Vedanta** (उत्तर मीमांसा / वेदांत - Badarayana) treats the Upanishads. Kapila is **not** Vedanta.
7. **Shankara** taught **Advaita** (अद्वैतवाद). **Ramanuja** taught **Vishishtadvaita** (विशिष्टद्वैतवाद). **Madhva** taught **Dvaita** (द्वैतवाद). **Nimbarka** taught **Dvaitadvaita** (द्वैताद्वैतवाद). **Vallabha** taught **Shuddhadvaita** (शुद्धाद्वैतवाद).
8. **Theravada** (थेरवाद) aims at the arhat and uses Pali. **Mahayana** (महायान) aims at the Bodhisattva and uses Sanskrit.
9. **Parshva** taught four vows. **Mahavira** added **Brahmacharya** (ब्रह्मचर्य) as the fifth. The Svetambara canon has **12 Angas**.
10. **Digambara** monks are sky-clad and deny women monks. **Svetambara** (श्वेताम्बर) monks wear white and admit women monks.
11. **Anekantavada** (अनेकांतवाद) is many-sided reality. **Syadvada** (स्याद्वाद) is the seven-fold "syad" speech about that reality.
12. **Chishti** Sufis at Ajmer / Delhi favour **sama** (समा / महफ़िल-ए-समा) and qawwali (क़व्वाली). **Suhrawardi** is linked with Multan. **Nizamuddin Auliya** belongs to **Delhi**.
13. **Kumbh Mela** is UNESCO **intangible** heritage (**2017**). It is not a monument World Heritage site.
14. **Sringeri** is the southern matha. It is linked with **Yajurveda** (यजुर्वेद) and **Sureshvara**.
15. **Dwaraka** is the western matha. It is linked with **Samaveda** (सामवेद) and **Hastamalaka**.
16. **Puri / Govardhana** is the eastern matha. It is linked with **Rigveda** (ऋग्वेद) and **Padmapada**.
17. **Jyotirmath / Badrinath** is the northern matha. It is linked with **Atharvaveda** (अथर्ववेद) and **Totaka**.
18. **Charvaka** accepts **1** pramana — pratyaksha only.
19. **Bauddha** (typical) accepts **2** — pratyaksha and anumana.
20. **Samkhya / Yoga / Vaisheshika** accept **3** — pratyaksha, anumana, shabda.
21. **Nyaya** accepts **4** — those three plus upamana.
22. **Prabhakara Mimamsa** accepts **5** — adding arthapatti.
23. **Kumarila Mimamsa / Vedanta** accept **6** — adding anupalabdhi (non-perception).
24. **Rigveda** is the oldest Veda. Its priest is the **Hotr**. Its Upaveda is Ayurveda.
25. **Samaveda** is the Veda of melody. Its priest is the **Udgatr**. Its Upaveda is Gandharvaveda.
26. **Yajurveda** is the Veda of ritual and its priest is the **Adhvaryu**. It has Shukla and Krishna recensions. Its Upaveda is Dhanurveda.
27. **Atharvaveda** deals with spells and healing. Its Upaveda is Arthashastra / Shilpaveda in variant lists.
28. **Tat tvam asi** belongs to the **Chandogya** Upanishad.
29. **Brahman** is ultimate reality — not **Brahmin** (varna). Related ideas are Atman, karma, samsara, and moksha.
30. **Ananda** was the attendant. **Upali** recites the Vinaya.
31. **Sariputta** and **Moggallana** were the chief disciples.
32. **Anicca** means impermanence. **Anatta** (अनात्मवाद) means no permanent self (not Upanishadic Atman, not Jain jiva).
33. **Theravada / Hinayana** holds the Arhat ideal, uses Pali, and spread in Sri Lanka–Myanmar–Thailand.
34. **Mahayana** holds the Bodhisattva ideal (Avalokiteshvara / Padmapani, Manjushri, Maitreya, Tara, Vajrapani), uses Sanskrit, and spread in East Asia.
35. **Vajrayana** (वज्रयान) is tantric. It is strong in Tibet, Bhutan, Ladakh, and Sikkim.

Chapter 04: Indian Architecture

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Maratha Military Landscapes of India** entered the list in **2025** as India's **44th** property. The set covers **12** forts: eleven in Maharashtra and **Gingee** in Tamil Nadu.
2. **Moidams – the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty** at Charaideo in Assam entered the list in **2024** as India's **43rd** property.
3. **Nagara** (नागर शैली) temples have a curvilinear **shikhara** (शिखर) and generally no monumental gopuram.
4. **Dravida** (द्रविड़ शैली) temples have a pyramidal **vimana** (विमान) and a tall **gopuram** (गोपुरम).
5. **Vesara** (वेसर शैली) is the Deccan hybrid of Chalukya and Hoysala land.
6. **Konark** Sun Temple is a stone chariot of Surya with **24** wheels and **7** horses. Eastern Ganga **Narasimhadeva I** built it in the **13th** century. It is also called the **Black Pagoda**.
7. **Khajuraho** (खजुराहो) is a **Chandela** sandstone Nagara group in **Madhya Pradesh**, built in the **10th–12th** centuries. About **85** shrines were planned. About **25** still stand. Groups are Hindu and Jain.
8. **Kandariya Mahadeva** (कंदरिया महादेव), built by **Vidyadhara**, is the largest Khajuraho temple. **Matangeshvara** belongs to **Dhanga's** age.
9. **Markandeshwar** in Vidarbha is called the **Khajuraho of Vidarbha**. It is not Kailasa. It is not Bhimashankar.
10. **Modhera** (मोढेरा) Sun Temple belongs to Solanki **Bhima I**.
11. **Dilwara** (दिलवाड़ा) at Mount Abu is white **marble** Jain work of the same Solanki milieu.
12. **Rani ki Vav** (रानी की वाव) at Patan is a Solanki stepwell. UNESCO listed it in **2014**.
13. **Aihole** (ऐहोल) is the cradle of early Chalukya experiment. The **Lad Khan** temple stands there.
14. **Badami** has four caves. **Pattadakal** (पट्टदकल) mixes Nagara and Dravida. Hoysala Belur, Halebidu, and Somnathpur use soapstone star plans in the **Vesara** hybrid.
15. **Sanchi** has four **toranas** (तोरण). **Bharhut** is a Shunga railing campus. **Amaravati** (अमरावती) has ayaka platforms. **Dhamek** is at Sarnath. **Mahabodhi** (महाबोधि) is at Bodh Gaya.
16. **Karle** (कार्ले) is the largest surviving chaitya. Ajanta chaitya caves are **9, 10, 19, and 26**. **Kanheri** (कन्हेरी) holds more than **100** Buddhist caves on Mumbai's western fringe.
17. **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) is a Barabar cave. **Ajanta** (अजंता) is Buddhist only.
18. **Ellora** (एलोरा) caves **1–12** are Buddhist, **13–29** are Hindu, and **30–34** are Jain. **Kailasa** (कैलास) is cave **16**, cut under **Krishna I** in Dravida rock-cut form.
19. **Elephanta** (एलिफेंटा) is mainly **Shaiva**, with the Trimurti, under Rashtrakuta-age patronage. A smaller Buddhist group also exists.
20. **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) commemorates Akbar's **Gujarat** victory. It is not a monument for Jahangir's birth.
21. **Charbagh** (चारबाग़) is the Islamic four-part garden plan. **Panchayatana** (पंचायतन शैली) is the Hindu five-shrine plan with a central sanctum and four corner shrines.
22. **Martand** (मार्तंड) Sun Temple of Lalitaditya in Kashmir belongs with Konark and Modhera as a sun temple. It is not a latina Nagara shrine of the Gangetic plain.
23. **Morena Chausath Yogini**, built by Kachchhapaghata **Devapala**, is a circular hypaethral temple. It is not the Khajuraho Chausath Yogini. Popular belief links its plan to the Indian Parliament building. It is not India's only circular temple.
24. **Palitana** (पालिताना) Jain temples stand on **Shatrunjaya** hill near Bhavnagar in Gujarat. The main dedication is to **Adinatha**.
25. **Sonagiri** near **Datia** in Madhya Pradesh is a Digambar Jain hill of about **103** temples. Main shrine number 57 honours **Chandraprabhu**.
26. **Angkor Wat** in Cambodia was built by Khmer **Suryavarman II** for **Vishnu**. **Borobudur** on Java in Indonesia is a UNESCO Buddhist monument.
27. **Virupaksha** (विरूपाक्ष) at **Hampi** (हम्पी) is a living Vijayanagara Shiva shrine. Do not confuse it with **Virupaksha** at **Pattadakal**.
28. **Teli ka Mandir** at Gwalior mixes a **Dravida-type** tower with northern ornament. Treat it as a fusion trap.
29. **Ellora** is not Saka. **Meenakshi** is Nayaka Madurai, not Pallava. **Mahabalipuram** (महाबलीपुरम) is Pallava, not Rashtrakuta. The **Besnagar Heliodorus** pillar is a **Vaishnava Garuda**, not a Shaiva cave.

30. **Sittanavasal** (सित्तन्नवासल) is a **Jain** cave shrine of Pallava age. Ajanta is Buddhist. Full mural detail lives in the Painting chapter.
31. **Dvarapalas** are door guardians carved at the sanctum entrance.
32. **Mithuna** couples appear on outer walls of developed Nagara temples, as at Khajuraho.
33. **Panchayatana** (पंचायतन) places a central shrine with four smaller shrines at the corners. Gupta Deogarh is the early type.
34. **Nagara** is the north Indian style, mainly north of the Vindhyas.
35. **Dravida** is the south Indian style.

Chapter 05: Indian Painting

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Pithora** (पिथौरा) painting of the Rathwa of Gujarat saw a GI-led livelihood push in **2025–26**. It is folk wall art. It is not a Mughal school.
2. **Madhubani** (मधुबनी) carries a GI tag. It is not a UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage element.
3. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) rock shelters are in Raisen, **Madhya Pradesh. V.S. Wakankar** demonstrated their prehistoric importance in **1957**. They are UNESCO **2003**, not fresco.
4. **Mirzapur–Sonbhadra** holds the main **UP** prehistoric rock-art belt. **Bagh** caves are in **Madhya Pradesh**, not UP.
5. **Rajput** painting is Rajasthan princely and bhakti / ragamala based. **Pahari** painting is Himalayan hill painting. Kangra is hills, not Rajasthan plains.
6. **Garhwal** is a Pahari school. **Mola Ram** (मोला राम) is its named master. The line begins with **Shyamdas** and **Hardas** as *Tasbirdar* at Srinagar Garhwal in **1658**.
7. **Tanjore** painting uses gold foil and gems on wood. **Mysore** painting uses finer gesso and is less gem-studded.
8. **Srikalahasti Kalamkari** is temple pen-work. **Machilipatnam Kalamkari** is block-printed trade cloth.
9. **Cheriyal** is Telangana narrative scroll painting. **Manjusha** is Bihar's snake-theme scroll art of the Bhagalpur belt. **Tikuli** is glass-and-enamel craft painting linked with Bihar.
10. **Madhubani** has a GI tag. It is **not** UNESCO intangible heritage. Do not confuse GI with ICH.
11. **Ravi Varma** used oil and oleograph realism. **Abanindranath** led the Bengal School wash revival and painted **Bharat Mata** (भारत माता).
12. **Nandalal Bose** painted the Haripura Congress panels and Constitution illumination. The **Progressive Artists' Group** formed in **1947. Amrita Sher-Gil** painted *Three Girls*.
13. **Marwar**, **Bikaner**, and **Jaipur** are additional Rajasthani ateliers beside Mewar, Kishangarh, Bundi, and Kotah.
14. **Pithora** of the Rathwa (Gujarat / western Madhya Pradesh) is ritual wall painting, not a Mughal album style.
15. **Gond** painting of Madhya Pradesh uses dotted tree-and-animal patterning. Do not place Gond in Bihar or Maharashtra.
16. **Bhimbetka** is in Raisen, **MP**. It is UNESCO **2003**, with about **500** shelters.
17. **Adamgarh** is on the Narmada in **MP**.
18. **Pachmarhi** is in **MP**.
19. **Lakhudiyar** is in Almora, Uttarakhand ("one lakh caves").
20. **Kupgallu** is a Karnataka Neolithic site.
21. **Piklihal** is a Karnataka Neolithic site.
22. **Tekkalkota** is a Karnataka Neolithic site.
23. **Singhanpur** is in Raigarh.
24. **Mirzapur–Sonbhadra** holds **UP** rock shelters.
25. **Jogimara** in Ramgarh, Surguja (**Chhattisgarh**), dating to the **3rd–1st century BCE**, contains the earliest surviving Indian frescoes. The scenes portray secular dancers and animals rather than Buddhist narratives.
26. **Sitabenga** (सीताबेंगा) is in the same hills. There is a theatre / rest-house debate. Inscriptions are Brahmi–Magadhi.
27. **Rupabheda** is variety of forms / appearances.
28. **Pramanam** is proportion / measurement (iconometry).
29. **Bhava** is emotion / expression.
30. **Lavanyayojana (Lavanyam)** is grace / charm.
31. **Sadrisyam** is likeness / verisimilitude.
32. **Varnikabhangam** is mixing of colours and brush mastery.
33. **Ellora** (एलोरा) is sculpture-famous. Cave 32 (Indra Sabha) has some paint. It is still not an Ajanta-class painting site.
34. **Jogimara and Sitabenga** in Surguja/Ramgarh (Chhattisgarh) preserve the earliest surviving pre-Christian Indian frescoes.

35. **Ajanta** (अजंता) in Maharashtra contains world-renowned Buddhist rock-cut wall paintings executed between the **2nd century BCE and the 6th century CE**.

Chapter 06: Indian Music

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Hindustani** (हिंदुस्तानी) is the north Indian system of khayal / dhrupad, tabla / pakhawaj, and gharanas. **Carnatic** (कर्नाटक) is the south Indian system of kriti, **72** melakarta, and mridangam.
2. **Dhrupad** (ध्रुपद) is the oldest surviving classical form and uses **pakhawaj. Khayal** is dominant today and uses **tabla**.
3. **Thumri** (ठुमरी) is light romantic song of the Awadh–Banaras belt. **Tappa** (टप्पा) has camel-song origin and is linked with **Muhammad Shah**'s court, not Akbar.
4. **Tarana** (तराना) uses nonsense syllables. **Qawwali** is linked with **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) at Nizamuddin's circle.
5. **Gwalior** is the oldest khayal gharana. **Agra** (आगरा) gharana is of Agra city in UP. **Kirana** gharana is of Kirana village in the western UP belt.
6. **Rampur–Sahaswan** is an Uttar Pradesh gharana of refined taans; **Ustad Rashid Khan** belongs to this line.
7. **Mewati** gharana is bhajan-coloured khayal; **Pandit Jasraj** is its flagship name. **Bhendi Bazar** is a Mumbai gharana known for note-stretching.
8. **Dagar** bani leads the modern dhrupad revival. Early dhrupad patronage is linked with **Man Singh Tomar** of Gwalior. **Senia** is the **Tansen** instrumental line.
9. **Kirana** is strongly linked with **Bhimsen Joshi**. Do not place Maihar or Tyagaraja Aradhana inside UP.
10. **Sitar** and **sarod** are Tata instruments. **Imdadkhani / Etawah** is a major sitar gharana. **Maihar** disciples include **Ravi Shankar**, **Ali Akbar Khan**, and **Annapurna Devi**.
11. **Sarangi** is the classic bowed accompaniment of Hindustani vocal music. **Saraswati veena** and **rudra veena / been** are classical string pillars; rudra veena pairs with dhrupad.
12. **Tabla** pairs with khayal and thumri. **Pakhawaj** pairs with dhrupad. **Mridangam** (मृदंगम्) is the Carnatic primary drum.
13. **Shehnai** is the Hindustani reed of Banaras. **Nadaswaram** (नादस्वरम्) is the Carnatic temple reed. **Bansuri** (flute) is a sushira solo voice of Hindustani music.
14. **Tansen** (तानसेन) was a dhrupad master of Akbar's Navaratna, earlier at the court of Raja Ramchandra of Bhata / Rewa. He is not part of the Carnatic Trinity.
15. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** was founded in **1952** at New Delhi as the apex body for music, dance, and theatre.
16. **Harmonium** is a free-reed keyboard used widely in Hindustani accompaniment; it is not a classical Tata string.
17. **Indore** and **Delhi** appear as historic gharana place-names beside Gwalior, Agra, and Patiala; learn them as Hindustani houses, not Carnatic schools.
18. **Banaras** is a major tabla and thumri centre (Kishan Maharaj, Girija Devi). Do not collapse Banaras into only shehnai.
19. **Sangeet** is *gita* (vocal) + *vadya* (instrumental) + *nritya* (dance).
20. **Raga** is a melody framework. It is not "a Western scale." It has aroha, avarohana, vadi, samvadi, rasa, and often a time/season.
21. **Tala** is a repeating beat-cycle. **Teental** is **16**. Carnatic **Adi tala** is **8**.
22. **Natyashastra** is by Bharata. It treats music + dance + drama together.
23. **Brihaddeshi** is by Matanga. It has the first **raga** word.
24. **Sangeet Ratnakar** is by Sharngadeva. Later writers call him the ocean of music.
25. **Ragamala** (रागमाला) is by **Pundrik Vitthal**. It treats raga–ragini families. He also wrote *Sadragachandrodaya* and *Ragamanjari*.
26. **Rasa Kaumudi** is by **Sri Kantha**. It treats music, dance and rasa.
27. **Raga Vibodh / Ragavibodha** is by **Somanath** (~**1610**). It has janya–janaka talk. It describes veenas.
28. **Chaturdandi Prakashika** (चतुर्दंडी प्रकाशिका) is by **Venkatamakhin / Venkatraman**. It sets out theoretical **melakarta** (मेलकर्ता) for Carnatic.
29. **Swaramelakalanidhi** is by Ramamatya (if asked). It is earlier south raga grouping.
30. **Vadi** is the main note. **Samvadi** is the second main note.
31. **Vishnu Digambar Paluskar** stands for public concert + notation + Gandharva Mahavidyalaya.
32. **Dhrupad** is the oldest surviving art form. It is austere. The drum is **Pakhawaj**, not tabla.

33. **Khayal** (ख्याल) is the dominant concert form today. The drum is **Tabla**. It has bada (slow) + chhota (fast).
34. **Thumri** is light classical. It is romantic *bol banav*. Centres are **Lucknow** (लखनऊ) and **Banaras** (**UP**).
35. **Tarana** is attributed to Amir Khusrau. It uses rhythmic mnemonic syllables (*ta na na dere na*).

Chapter 07: Indian Dance

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Garba of Gujarat** entered the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage list in **December 2023**. It is a folk form. It is not one of the eight classical dances.
2. **Yamini Krishnamurthy**, a leading exponent of Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi, died on **3 August 2024**.
3. **Birju Maharaj** (बिरजू) of the Lucknow Kathak gharana died in **January 2022**.
4. **Kalbelia** (कालबेलिया) of Rajasthan entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**.
5. **Chhau** (छऊ) entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**. It is still not on the Sangeet Natak Akademi list of eight.
6. **Sankirtana** (संकीर्तन) of Manipur entered UNESCO ICH in **2013**. It is ritual music and dance. It is not a ninth classical dance.
7. **Chhau** (छऊ) is not one of those eight. It is UNESCO martial-folk. Some notes call it a ninth style. That is not the Akademi list.
8. **Bharatanatyam** (भरतनाट्यम्) belongs to Tamil Nadu.
9. **Kathak** (कथक) belongs to North India, with Lucknow in Uttar Pradesh as the main gharana.
10. **Kathakali** (कथकली) and **Mohiniyattam** (मोहिनीअट्टम्) both belong to Kerala.
11. **Kuchipudi** (कुचिपुड़ी) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
12. **Odissi** (ओडिसी) belongs to Odisha.
13. **Manipuri** (मणिपुरी) belongs to Manipur.
14. **Sattriya** (सत्रिया) belongs to Assam.
15. **Nritta** (नृत्त) is pure dance without a story. **Nritya** (नृत्य) adds expressive abhinaya. **Natya** (नाट्य) is dance-drama.
16. **Lasya** is graceful movement. **Tandava** (तांडव) is vigorous movement. Kerala's pair is male Kathakali tandava versus female Mohiniyattam lasya.
17. **Bharatanatyam** uses the **araimandi** (अरैमंडी) half-sit. It grew from temple **sadir**. **Rukmini Devi Arundale** and Kalakshetra led the modern stage revival.
18. **Kathak** is the only one of the eight that uses Hindustani music. Markers are **chakkar** (चक्कर) spins and **tatkar** (तत्कार) footwork.
19. **Kathakali** uses heavy **chutti** (चुट्टी) makeup. **Pacha** (पचा) green marks the noble hero. It is not north Indian Kathak.
20. **Kuchipudi** is Andhra village dance-drama. **Tarangam** (तरंगम्) is dancing on a brass plate.
21. **Mohiniyattam** is a Kerala female solo in white-and-gold kasavu. It uses Carnatic music.
22. **Odissi** uses the **tribhanga** (त्रिभंग) three-bend posture. Temple **mahari** women and boy **gotipua** (गोटिपुआ) dancers feed the tradition.
23. **Manipuri** classical dance centres on **Ras Lila** of Manipur. Braj **Raslila** (रासलीला) of Uttar Pradesh is a separate folk Krishna play.
24. **Sattriya** grew in Assam's **satra** monasteries from **Sankaradeva** (शंकरदेव). It is the latest of the official eight.
25. **Garba** (गरबा) of Gujarat entered UNESCO ICH in **2023**. It is still folk, not classical.
26. **Kalbelia** of Rajasthan entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**.
27. **Chhau** entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**. It is still not on the Akademi list of eight.
28. **Bhangra** (भांगड़ा) of Punjab, **Lavani** (लावणी) of Maharashtra, and **Bihu** (बिहू) of Assam are folk. They are not among the eight.
29. **Braj Raslila** is Uttar Pradesh folk. **Charkula** (चरकुला) is a Braj lamp-wheel dance. **Mayur** is the Braj peacock dance.
30. **Chholiya** (छोलिया) is a Kumaon sword dance. **Tharu** dance belongs to the Terai.
31. **Rukmini Devi Arundale** revived Bharatanatyam at Kalakshetra.
32. **Kelucharan Mohapatra** reconstructed concert Odissi.
33. **Birju Maharaj** is the Lucknow Kathak name.
34. **Vallathol Narayana Menon** is linked with Kerala Kalamandalam, Kathakali, and Mohiniyattam.
35. **Yamini Krishnamurthy** danced Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi. She died on **3 August 2024**.

Chapter 08: Indian Theatre & Performing Arts

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Koodiyattam** (कूड़ियाट्टम्) was proclaimed a UNESCO masterpiece in **2001** and entered the Representative List in **2008**.
2. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) entered UNESCO ICH in **2008**.
3. **Mudiyettu** (मुडियेट्टु) of Kerala entered UNESCO ICH in **2010**. It is ritual theatre, not Kathakali.
4. **Natyashastra** (नाट्यशास्त्र) by **Bharata Muni** (भरत मुनि) (about **200 BCE–200 CE**) codifies drama with about **10** rupaka (रूपक), **9** rasa (रस), and four abhinaya (अभिनय).
5. **Abhinavabharati** (अभिनवभारती) is Abhinavagupta's (अभिनवगुप्त) commentary on Natyashastra. **Dasharupaka** (दशरूपक) is Dhananjaya's (धनंजय) later summary of play types.
6. **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) is often tagged with the earliest Sanskrit play tradition. **Bhasa** (भास) left about **13** plays. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) wrote **three** dramas.
7. **Shudraka** (शूद्रक) wrote *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्). **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) wrote *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस). **Bhavabhuti** (भवभूति) wrote *Uttararamacharita* (उत्तररामचरित). King **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली).
8. **Yavanika** (यवनिका) is the stage curtain. **Nepathya** (नेपथ्य) is the backstage dressing room. **Sutradhara** (सूत्रधार) is the director and narrator-presenter.
9. **Koodiyattam** is UNESCO living Sanskrit theatre (proclaimed **2001**, list **2008**). It is theatre, not a ninth SNA classical dance.
10. **Nautanki** (नौटंकी) is the high-yield **UP** folk opera, named in the *Ain-i-Akbari*, with **Kanpur** and **Lucknow** schools and the **nagara** (नगाड़ा) drum.
11. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) of Ramnagar–Varanasi / Braj is UNESCO **2008**. **Raslila** (रासलीला) is the Braj Krishna folk play, not Manipuri classical Ras Lila.
12. **Swang** (स्वांग) belongs to Haryana, western UP, and Rajasthan. **Tamasha** (तमाशा) of Maharashtra uses **Lavani** (लावणी) and often has women playing male roles.
13. **Jatra** (यात्रा) belongs to Bengal and Odisha. **Yakshagana** (यक्षगान) belongs to coastal Karnataka. **Bhavai** (भवई) belongs to Gujarat.
14. **Bhaona** (भाओना) stages **Ankiya Nat** (अंकिया नाट) in the satras of Majuli, Assam. **Ramman** (रम्माण) is the sacred masked ritual theatre of Uttarakhand. **Powada** (पोवाड़ा) belongs to Maharashtra. **Burrakatha** (बुराकथा) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
15. **Kathputli** (कठपुतली) of Rajasthan is string marionette, often without carved legs. **Gulabo–Sitabo** (गुलाबो-सीताबो) of **Lucknow** are glove comic puppets.
16. **Kundhei** (कुंधेई) is Odisha string puppetry. **Tholu Bommalata** (तोलू बोम्मलता) of Andhra Pradesh and **Ravana Chhaya** (रावण छाया) of Odisha are shadow forms.
17. **Bidesiya** (बिदेसिया) is a migration-themed folk play of the Bhojpuri belt of eastern Uttar Pradesh and western Bihar. In Banaras, **Bhartendu Harishchandra** (भारतेन्दु हरिश्चंद्र) laid the foundation of modern Hindi drama.
18. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) (**1952**) covers music, dance, **and theatre**. It is not a dance-only body.
19. **Nataka** (नाटक) is a mythic heroic play type. **Prakarana** (प्रकरण) invents a social plot. Do not confuse **natya** (नाट्य, drama) with **nritta** (नृत्त, pure dance).
20. **Indra Sabha**, composed by **Agha Hasan Amanat** and performed at **Lucknow in 1853**, is the milestone Urdu-Awadhi musical play patronized by the court of Awadh.
21. **Badal Sircar** is linked to Third Theatre (street, no proscenium).
22. **Nautanki** (नौटंकी) belongs to **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश). It is folk opera and an offshoot of Swang. It is named in **Ain-i-Akbari**.
23. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) belongs to **UP** (Ramnagar–Varanasi, Braj). It is for Dussehra and is UNESCO **2008** (proclaimed 2005). Traditionally men play Sita too.
24. **Raslila** (रासलीला) is the **Braj / Mathura–Vrindavan** Krishna play. Manipuri Ras Lila is classical dance of Manipur, not this Braj folk play.
25. **Swang** (स्वांग) belongs to Haryana, western **UP**, and Rajasthan. It is satire. Men play women.
26. **Jatra** (यात्रा) belongs to Bengal and Odisha. It is open-air, and Chaitanya used it for Krishna-bhakti. The Odisha street variant is **Sahi Jatra** (साही यात्रा).

27. **Tamasha** (तमाशा) belongs to Maharashtra. It uses **Lavani** (लावणी). **Women even play male roles** (opposite of Swang).
28. **Yakshagana** (यक्षगान) belongs to coastal **Karnataka**. It is all-night, on Vijayanagara court soil, and in Kannada.
29. **Bhavai** (भवई) belongs to Gujarat (Kutch–Kathiawar). It uses vesha/swanga skits. The sutradhara is called **Nayaka**.
30. **Bhand Pather** (भांड पाथर) belongs to Kashmir. It is satire. Muslim performers tell secular stories.
31. **Maach** (माच) belongs to Malwa / Ujjain, MP. Couplets are called *rangat doha*.
32. **Therukoothu** (तेरुक्कूत्तु) is Tamil Nadu street theatre.
33. **Dashavatar** (दशावतार) belongs to Konkan (Sindhudurg–Goa). It presents ten Vishnu avatars.
34. **Ankiya Nat** (अंकिया नाट) belongs to Assam and is linked to **Sankaradeva** (शंकरदेव). It is one-act and uses masks. Musicians are Gayan–Bayan (khol).
35. **Bhaona** (भाओना) is the dramatic staging of Srimanta Sankaradeva's Ankiya Nat, traditionally preserved and enacted in the Vaishnavite satras of **Majuli Island** in Assam.

Chapter 09: Indian Languages & Literature

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Yuva Puraskar** is Sahitya Akademi's prize for writers of **35** and under. It is not Jnanpith.
2. **Shruti** (श्रुति) is the heard Veda stack of Samhita (संहिता), Brahmana (ब्राह्मण), Aranyaka (आरण्यक), and Upanishad (उपनिषद्). **Smriti** (स्मृति) covers epics, Puranas, Dharmashastra, and related remembered texts.
3. **Valmiki**'s (वाल्मीकि) *Ramayana* (रामायण) has **seven** kandas. **Vyasa**'s (व्यास) *Mahabharata* (महाभारत) has **eighteen** parvas. The *Bhagavad Gita* (भगवद्गीता) sits inside **Bhishma Parva** (भीष्म पर्व).
4. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) wrote *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Raghuvamsha* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव), and *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार). His three dramas are *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Vikramorvashiya* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्), and *Malavikagnimitram* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्).
5. **Trivikrama Bhatta** (त्रिविक्रम भट्ट) wrote *Nalachampu* (नलचम्पू). **Somadeva** (सोमदेव) wrote *Kathasaritsagara* (कथासरित्सागर). **Jayadeva** (जयदेव) wrote *Gita Govinda* (गीत गोविंद). **Kshemendra** (क्षेमेन्द्र) wrote *Brihatkathamanjari* (बृहत्कथामंजरी).
6. **Charaka** (चरक) wrote the *Charaka Samhita* (चरक संहिता). **Sushruta** (सुश्रुत) wrote the *Sushruta Samhita* (सुश्रुत संहिता). **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote the *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय). **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote the *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता).
7. **Ashvaghosha** (अश्वघोष) wrote *Buddhacharita* (बुद्धचरित) and *Saundarananda* (सौंदरानंद). **Bhasa** (भास) left about **13** plays. King **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), *Nagananda* (नागानन्द), and *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका).
8. **Amir Khusrau** (अमीर खुसरो) wrote in Persian and early Hindavi. He served under multiple Delhi Sultanate rulers and coined the phrase about the Indian parrot (*Tuti-i-Hind*).
9. **Basaveshwara** (बसवेश्वर) wrote Kannada vachanas. **Jnaneshwar** (ज्ञानेश्वर) wrote the Marathi *Jnaneshwari* (ज्ञानेश्वरी). **Alvars** (आलवार) composed the *Nalayira Divya Prabandham* (नालायिर दिव्य प्रबंधम्).
10. **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote the Awadhi *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस). **Surdas** (सूरदास) wrote Braj *Sursagar* (सूरसागर). **Malik Muhammad Jayasi** (मलिक मुहम्मद जायसी) wrote the Awadhi *Padmavat* (पद्मावत).
11. **Bhartendu Harishchandra** (भारतेन्दु हरिश्चंद्र) of Banaras is the father of modern Hindi dramatic and prose literature.
12. **Kamban** (कंबन) wrote *Ramavataram* (रामावतारम्), the Tamil Ramayana. ***Tirumurai*** (तिरुमुरै) is the Saiva hymn corpus treated as a Fifth Veda of Tamil Shaivism.
13. **Alvars** number **12** (Vaishnava); **Nayanars** (नायनार) number **63** (Shaiva). Do not reverse the counts.
14. **Panini** (पाणिनि) wrote the *Ashtadhyayi* (अष्टाध्यायी). **Patanjali** (पतंजलि) wrote the *Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य). **Yaska** (यास्क) wrote the *Nirukta* (निरुक्त). **Katyayana** (कात्यायन) wrote the *Varttika* (वार्त्तिक). Panini is not a Pushyamitra court poet. Patanjali is Shunga-linked.
15. **Kalhana**'s *Rajatarangini* is the Sanskrit chronicle of **Kashmir** kings, completed under **Jayasimha / Jai Singh (1128–1149)**, in **eight** tarangas. Continuators are **Jonaraja** and **Srivara**.
16. **Harsha** (हर्ष) wrote *Ratnavali* (रत्नावली), *Priyadarshika* (प्रियदर्शिका), and *Nagananda* (नागानन्द). *Harshacharita* and *Kadambari* are **Banabhatta**. *Karpuramanjari* (कर्पूरमंजरी) is **Rajasekhara** (राजशेखर), not Harsha.
17. **Sriharsha** (श्रीहर्ष) wrote *Naishadhiyacharita* (नैषधीयचरित). **Bharavi** (भारवि) wrote *Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय). **Magha** (माघ) wrote *Shishupalavadha* (शिशुपालवध). *Dashakumaracharita* (दशकुमारचरित) by **Dandin** (दंडी) is not a Mahabharata theme.
18. **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका) (based on **Greek** astronomy), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता) (encyclopedic), and *Brihat Jataka* (बृहज्जातक). *Amarakosha* (अमरकोश) is **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह), not Varaha.
19. **Charaka Samhita** (चरक संहिता) is Ayurveda medicine in **120 chapters** and **eight** sections. **Bhaskara II**'s (भास्कर द्वितीय) *Siddhantashiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि) has four parts: *Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Bijaganita* (बीजगणित), *Ganitadhyaya* (गणिताध्याय), *Goladhyaya* (गोलाध्याय) (algebra fame).
20. **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय); earth is spherical and rotates; often tagged for trigonometry and decimal place-value teaching. **Zero** as a numeral is credited to an **anonymous Indian** (Arabs used it by **873 CE**).
21. **Manusmriti** (मनुस्मृति) is mainly the social and law system. **Mitakshara** (मिताक्षरा) is **Vijnaneshwara** (विज्ञानेश्वर) on Yajnavalkya. **Dayabhaga** (दायाभाग) is **Jimutavahana** (जीमूतवाहन).
22. **Vishakhadatta** (विशाखदत्त) also wrote *Devichandraguptam* (देवीचन्द्रगुप्तम्) (do not assign it to **Bilhana** (बिल्हण)).
23. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) belongs to the Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) tradition.
24. **Amarasimha** (अमरसिंह) belongs to Chandragupta II's Navaratna circle. He is **not** Harshavardhana's poet.

25. **Sriharsha** (श्रीहर्ष) wrote *Naishadhiyacharita* (नैषधीयचरित) on **Nala and Damayanti**.
26. **Bharavi** (भारवि) wrote *Kiratarjuniya* (किरातार्जुनीय) on Arjuna's combat with Shiva as a kirata.
27. **Magha** (माघ) wrote *Shishupalavadha* (शिशुपालवध) on Krishna and Shishupala.
28. **Dandin** (दंडी) wrote *Dashakumaracharita* (दशकुमारचरित) (adventures of ten princes) and *Kavyadarsha* (काव्यादर्श). It is **not** a Mahabharata-theme epic.
29. **Kalhana** (कल्हण) wrote *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी), a metrical Sanskrit chronicle of the kings of **Kashmir**.
30. **Jonaraja** (जोनराज) continued the narrative into the Sultanate age (to Zain-ul-Abidin). His pupil **Srivara** (श्रीवर) continued after Jonaraja.
31. **Vakpati** (वाकपति) wrote the Prakrit *Gaudavaho* (गौडवहो) on the digvijaya of **Yasovarman** (यशोवर्मन) of Kannauj — a historical poem often paired with *Rajatarangini* in stems.
32. **Bilhana** (बिल्हण) wrote *Vikramankadevacharita* (विक्रमांकदेवचरित). **Merutunga** (मेरुतुंग) wrote *Prabandha Chintamani* (प्रबंध चिंतामणि). **Padmagupta** (पद्मगुप्त) wrote *Navasahasankacharita* (नवसाहसांकचरित) on **Paramara** (परमार) origin lore.
33. **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर) wrote *Panchasiddhantika* (पंचसिद्धांतिका) (based on **Greek** astronomy), *Brihatsamhita* (बृहत्संहिता) (encyclopedic), and *Brihat Jataka* (बृहज्जातक).
34. **Aryabhata** (आर्यभट) wrote *Aryabhatiya* (आर्यभटीय) covering arithmetic, algebra, plane and spherical trigonometry, and astronomy. He taught that the earth is **spherical** and **rotates** on its axis. He is often called a pioneer of trigonometry and linked with decimal place-value teaching.
35. **Bhaskara II (Bhaskaracharya)** (भास्कर द्वितीय) wrote *Siddhantashiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि) in four parts: *Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Bijaganita* (बीजगणित) (algebra), *Ganitadhyaya* (गणिताध्याय), and *Goladhyaya* (गोलाध्याय). He is the usual "algebra" name in options.

Chapter 10: Indian Festivals & Fairs

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Maha Kumbh** at Prayagraj ran from **13 January to 26 February 2025**, about **45** days.
2. **Pushkar Kumbh** of **May 2025** was at Mana / Keshav Prayag in **Uttarakhand** (उत्तराखंड). It is not the Rajasthan camel fair.
3. **Garba** (गरबा) of Gujarat entered UNESCO ICH in **December 2023**.
4. **Durga Puja of Kolkata** entered UNESCO ICH in **2021**.
5. **Kumbh Mela** (कुंभ मेला) entered UNESCO ICH in **2017**.
6. **Kumbh Mela** is on the UNESCO Intangible Heritage list from **2017. Magh Mela** is the annual bathing fair at Prayagraj; it is not the twelve-year mega Kumbh at every site.
7. **Pushkar Fair** (पुष्कर मेला) is the **Rajasthan** (थार) camel and livestock fair of **Kartik** near Ajmer. **Pushkar Kumbh** of May **2025** was at **Mana / Keshav Prayag** in **Uttarakhand**, not Rajasthan and not Uttar Pradesh.
8. **Pongal** (पोंगल) is the **Tamil Nadu** January harvest festival. **Onam** (ओणम) is the **Kerala** Aug–Sep harvest linked to Mahabali. Do not swap the two states.
9. **Bihu** (बिहू) is the **Assam** harvest trio. **Hornbill** is the **Nagaland** cultural showcase at **Kisama**, usually **1–10 December**.
10. **Baisakhi** (बैसाखी) and **Lohri** belong to **Punjab** (Lohri also Haryana–Himachal). **Nuakhai** (नुआखाइ) is the **Odisha** (ओडिशा) harvest. **Vishu** (विशु) is the **Kerala** New Year, not Ugadi.
11. **Ugadi** (उगादि) is New Year in **Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka. Gudi Padwa** is the **Maharashtra** New Year in the same season. **Bathukamma** (बतुकम्मा) is the **Telangana** floral festival.
12. **Garba / Dandiya** is **Gujarat** Navratri dance and UNESCO ICH from **2023. Bhangra / Giddha** is **Punjab** harvest dance at Baisakhi. Garba is not a ninth SNA classical.
13. **Durga Puja of Kolkata** is UNESCO ICH from **2021. Navratri** is the nine-night goddess cycle; Gujarat's Garba sits inside Navratri, not inside Bengal pandals alone.
14. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) is the Ramayana play on UNESCO ICH from **2008. Dussehra / Vijayadashami** is the Ravana-effigy day. Ramlila is theatre, not classical dance.
15. **Sarhul** (सरहुल) is the **Jharkhand** tribal sal-flower festival. **Bastar Dussehra** in **Chhattisgarh** lasts about **75** days around Danteshwari and is not Rama–Ravana Dussehra.
16. **Medaram Jatara** (मेदारम जातरा) is the **Telangana** Koya tribal pilgrimage. **Bhagoria** (भगोरिया) is the **Madhya Pradesh** Bhil festival. **Wangala** is the **Meghalaya** Garo harvest. **Chapchar Kut** (चपचार कुट) is **Mizoram. Sangai** is **Manipur**.
17. **Surajkund** (सूरजकुंड) crafts mela is in **Haryana** in February. It is not Rajasthan and not Uttar Pradesh.
18. **Sonepur** cattle fair is in **Bihar. Gangasagar** mela is in **West Bengal. Ambubachi** is at Kamakhya in Assam.
19. **Chhath** is sun worship on eastern UP–Bihar–Jharkhand ghats. It is not moon worship.
20. **Deva Mela** is held at **Barabanki**, while the historic **Bateshwar Fair** takes place in **Agra** (आगरा) district. Mourning processions of Muharram represent an integral part of the Shia cultural tradition in Lucknow.
21. **Eid-ul-Fitr** ends Ramadan. **Eid-ul-Adha** is Bakrid, the sacrifice festival. Do not treat them as one festival.
22. **Kullu Dussehra** is Himachal. **Ratha Yatra** of Puri is Odisha. **Ganesh Chaturthi** (गणेश चतुर्थी) is Maharashtra's flagship. **Hemis** is the Ladakh monastery festival.
23. **Andhra Pradesh**: Celebrates **Ugadi** (the Telugu New Year) as its premier state festival.
24. **Arunachal Pradesh**: Marks the Buddhist New Year with **Losar** and the Theravada Buddhist water festival **Sangken** (community New Year among Tai groups such as Khamti). Celebrated tribal festivals include **Solung** and **Mopin** (both **Adi** agricultural festivals) and **Nyokum** (Nyishi tribe).
25. **Assam**: Anchors its cultural calendar around the three **Bihu** harvest festivals (Rongali, Kongali, Bhogali); the sacred **Ambubachi Mela** is observed annually at the Kamakhya Temple in Guwahati.
26. **Bihar**: Celebrates **Chhath Puja** (dedicated to the Sun God) as its paramount cultural festival and hosts the historic **Sonepur Cattle Fair** (Asia's largest animal fair at Harihar Kshetra).
27. **Chhattisgarh**: Renowned for the unique 75-day-long **Bastar Dussehra**, honoring the local patron deity Goddess Danteshwari.
28. **Goa**: Celebrates the vibrant pre-Lenten **Goa Carnival** and the joyous spring festival of **Shigmo** (the Goan counterpart of Holi).

29. **Gujarat**: Celebrates nine nights of **Navratri** (नवरात्रि) with community **Garba** and Dandiya Raas (inscribed on UNESCO ICH in 2023), alongside **Uttarayan** (the International Kite Festival on Makar Sankranti).
30. **Haryana**: Hosts the globally acclaimed **Surajkund International Crafts Mela** annually in February at Faridabad.
31. **Himachal Pradesh**: Renowned for the week-long **Kullu Dussehra**, commencing on Vijayadashami day in the Dhalpur ground of Kullu.
32. **Jharkhand**: Celebrates **Sarhul** (the tribal festival of the Sal tree blossoms), alongside **Karma Puja** and extensive observances of **Chhath Puja** across the plateau.
33. **Karnataka**: Celebrates the grand ten-day **Mysore Dasara** (featuring the Jamboo Savari elephant procession), alongside **Ugadi** (Kannada New Year) and the **Hampi Utsav**.
34. **Kerala**: Celebrates **Onam** as its signature harvest festival (commemorating King Mahabali), alongside the vibrant elephant and percussion spectacle **Thrissur Pooram** and the astronomical New Year **Vishu**.
35. **Madhya Pradesh**: Hosts the premier classical **Khajuraho Dance Festival**, the prestigious **Tansen Samaroh** (classical music festival in Gwalior), and the vibrant tribal **Bhagoria** festival among the Bhils.

Chapter 11: Ancient Indian History Related to Culture

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Mandi** and **Hulas** are Indus sites in Uttar Pradesh. **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी) is in Haryana.
2. **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा) entered the UNESCO World Heritage list in **2021**.
3. **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) entered the UNESCO World Heritage list in **2026**.
4. **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** is the diagnostic deluxe pottery of the Mauryan and Northern Black Polished Ware period, while the classical Buddhist rock-cut murals of **Ajanta** (अजंता) represent the zenith of **Gupta–Vakataka** painting.
5. **Mauryan polish** (मौर्य) on **Chunar** (चुनार) sandstone (Mirzapur belt) gives a mirror finish. The **Didarganj Yakshi** (दीदारगंज यक्षी) is the classic Mauryan polish figure.
6. **Bharhut** (भरहुत) and early **Sanchi** (सांची) are **Shunga** narrative reliefs. Early Sanchi is largely **aniconic** (अप्रतिमेय) (wheel, tree, throne), not a human Buddha.
7. **Rock-cut** architecture (Barabar, chaityas) is carved into living rock. **Structural** temples are built from the Gupta age onward as freestanding buildings.
8. **Rakhigarhi** is in **Haryana** and is the largest Indus site in India. It is **not** in Uttar Pradesh.
9. **Sanauli** (सनौली) (Baghpat district, UP) is a late Harappan / Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP) burial site famous for the discovery of copper-plated **war chariots**, coffins, and weaponry, representing a distinct post-urban transitional phase.
10. **Chanhudaro** (चन्हूदड़ो) served as a specialized Indus bead-making and craft workshop centre; silver and copper punch-marked coins (*karshapanas*) served as the primary currency under the Mauryas, whereas the Guptas issued magnificent die-struck gold coins known as **dinara** (दीनार).
11. **Wootz steel** represents the renowned crucible high-carbon steel developed in ancient South India and traded across the ancient Mediterranean and West Asian worlds.
12. **Mathura** is the red-sandstone school home in UP. **Sarnath** is known for the **Lion Capital** and the Gupta Buddha. **Bhitargaon** is a Gupta brick temple in the Kanpur belt.
13. **Ahichhatra** (अहिच्छत्र) and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी) are terracotta and urban craft centres of Uttar Pradesh.
14. **Bhimbetka** (MP) is famous for prehistoric rock paintings of animals and hunters. It is a UNESCO site. It is not a Gupta temple.
15. **Steatite seals** show a unicorn or humped bull plus undeciphered script. They served as trade and identity marks.
16. **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** is Mauryan elite glossy pottery. It is not Harappan.
17. **Mauryan** sculpture uses Chunar sandstone. It has a mirror polish and animal capitals.
18. **Bharhut** has Shunga narrative railings. They show early Buddhist stories in relief.
19. **Sanchi** toranas are mature Shunga–Satavahana narrative gateways. They stand in MP.
20. **Gandhara sculpture uses grey** schist** (also stucco). The Buddha is Greco-Roman / Hellenistic, with wavy hair, drapery and an Apollo-like face. The school is in the NW (Peshawar–Taxila belt).
21. **Mathura** sculpture uses **red sandstone**. It shows an indigenous Buddha and Jina. The centre is in **Uttar Pradesh** (उत्तर प्रदेश), peaking under the Kushans and continuing into the Gupta age.
22. **Amaravati** (अमरावती) sculpture uses white / greenish **limestone**. It is from Andhra and shows dynamic narrative and movement.
23. **Gupta / Sarnath** sculpture is the classical ideal. It shows transparent drapery and the **Dharmachakra mudra** (धर्मचक्र मुद्रा) Buddha.
24. **IVC cities** had grid streets, a citadel and lower town, burnt brick and **covered drains**.
25. **Lothal** (लोथल) had a dockyard in Gujarat. Terracotta boat models are found there.
26. **Dholavira** is known for reservoirs and water management. It is in Gujarat and became UNESCO-listed in **2021**.
27. **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा) is in Rajasthan. It has ploughed-field evidence (agriculture overlap) and fire altars.
28. **Rakhigarhi** is in **Haryana**. It is the largest Indian IVC site. It is **not** in UP.
29. **Manda** is in Jammu & Kashmir (northern edge). **Padri** is in Gujarat. **Balu** is in Haryana.
30. **Sanauli** (Baghpat, UP) is a late Harappan / OCP chariot burial. It is not a substitute for Alamgirpur in “easternmost” questions.

31. **Ashoka pillars** are monolithic with Mauryan polish. Megasthenes describes a wooden palace at Pataliputra.
32. **Barabar** caves are in Bihar. They are the earliest surviving rock-cut caves, given by **Ashoka / Dasharatha** to the **Ajivikas** (आजीविक). They are not Chandragupta's donation card.
33. **Cotton** cultivation and textile evidence begin in the IVC. Cotton is not a colonial crop.
34. **Kalibangan** preserves a **ploughed field**.
35. **Rigvedic** society is mainly **pastoral**. Cattle counted as wealth.

Chapter 12: Medieval Indian Cultural History (इतिहास)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Fatehpur Sikri** (फतेहपुर सीकरी), the **Taj Mahal** (ताज महल), and **Humayun (हुमायूँ)'s Tomb** remain UNESCO World Heritage (विश्व धरोहर) monuments. Tomb–city pairs and **Buland Darwaza** (बुलंद दरवाज़ा) still sit in the standing Mughal (मुग़ल) set.
2. **Humayun** brought Persian (फ़ारसी) masters **Mir Sayyid (सैयद) Ali** and **Abdus Samad. Akbar** built the **kitabkhana** (किताबखाना) and the illustrated **Razmnama (रज्मनामा). Jahangir (जहाँगीर)** favoured naturalism under painters such as **Mansur**. Under Aurangzeb (औरंगजेब) many painters left the imperial atelier.
3. **Buland Darwaza** at Fatehpur Sikri marks Akbar's (अकबर) **Gujarat victory**. It is **not** a monument for Jahangir's birth in **1569**.
4. **Babur** wrote his memoir (*Tuzuk-i-Baburi* (तुजुक-ए-बाबरी)) in **Chagatai (चगताई) Turki (तुर्की)**. The Mughal **court language** was **Persian**. Do not swap the two.
5. **Abul Fazl** (अबुल फजल) wrote the narrative **Akbarnama** (अकबरनामा) and the gazetteer **Ain-i-Akbari (आइन-ए-अकबरी). Faizi (फैजी)** was the court poet. **Nakhshabi** wrote the *Tutinama*.
6. **Zabt** (जब्त) is measured land assessment. **Dahsala** (दहसाला) is Todar Mal (टोडर मल)'s **ten-year** average revenue system from about **1580**.
7. **Ibadat Khana** (इबादत खाना) debates began at Fatehpur Sikri in **1575. Sulh-i-kul (सुलह-ए-कुल)** was the public peace policy. **Din-i-Ilahi** (दीन-ए-इलाही) of **1582** was a private fellowship, not a state religion.
8. **Tulsidas** (तुलसीदास) wrote the Awadhi (अवधी) *Ramcharitmanas* (रामचरितमानस) in Akbar's age. **Kavindra Acharya** of Banaras is linked to Shah Jahan's court culture.
9. **Alai Darwaza** is an Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) gateway at the Qutub complex. It is not a Sharqi Jaunpur monument.
10. **Fatehpur Sikri** is Akbar's planned capital near Agra. It holds Buland Darwaza and the Ibadat Khana, not Shah Jahan's Taj.
11. **Akbarnama** tells the reign story. **Ain-i-Akbari** (आइन-ए-अकबरी) is the administrative and statistical companion. Papers often swap the two titles.
12. **Zat** ranks the man's personal status. **Sawar** ranks the horsemen he must maintain. High zat with low sawar is a classic trap pattern.
13. **Iqta** revenue stayed with the muqti for troops. **Khalsa** revenue went to the treasury under direct officials. Do not call jagirs "direct crown land."
14. **Din-i-Ilahi** never replaced Islam as state religion. **Sulh-i-kul** (सुलह-ए-कुल) is the broader public tolerance policy examined more often than the private cult.
15. **Jaunpur** Sharqi architecture (शर्की स्थापत्य) is a regional Sultanate style of eastern UP. It is not Delhi Slave or Khalji architecture.
16. **Akbar** (अकबर) runs the imperial **kitabkhana**. Indian colour and costume fuse with Persian composition.
17. **Jahangir** marks the naturalism peak. **Ustad Mansur** is famed for birds and animals.
18. **Pietra dura** (पिएत्रा ड्यूरा) (*parchin kari*) stone inlay represents the quintessential decorative art of Shah Jahan's monuments, most exquisitely displayed at the Taj Mahal.
19. **Qutub Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) was started by **Aibak** and finished by **Iltutmish** (इल्तुतमिश). It stands in Delhi.
20. **Alai Darwaza** is by Alauddin Khalji. It is an early true-arch gateway.
21. **Sharqi Jaunpur (UP)** is known for **Atala Masjid**. It has a big screen-facade and weak minaret emphasis. It is not a Delhi clone.
22. **Lal Darwaza Masjid** is at Jaunpur. It is the correct UP pair.
23. **Adina Masjid** is at **Pandua / Bengal**, not Mandu (मांडू) — the classic unmatched pair in match lists.
24. **Humayun's Tomb** stands in **Delhi**. It has a charbagh and a double dome. Haji Begum is associated with it.
25. **Fatehpur Sikri** was Akbar's capital (about **1571–1585**). It was abandoned (water).
26. **Buland Darwaza** is at Fatehpur Sikri. It commemorates the **Gujarat victory (1573)**. It does **not** mark Jahangir's birth (**1569**).
27. **Panch Mahal** (पंच महल) is a five-storey open pavilion at Fatehpur Sikri. It is not the victory gate.
28. **Agra Fort** (आगरा किला) has Akbar's red-sandstone base. Shah Jahan's marble palaces stand inside.
29. **Itimad-ud-Daulah** stands at Agra. It belongs to Nur Jahan (नूरजहाँ)'s father. It uses marble and pietra dura before the Taj.
30. **Bibi ka Maqbara** (बीबी का मकबरा) is Aurangzeb-era, at Aurangabad. It is called the "Poor man's Taj."

31. **Babur**'s tomb city is **Kabul**.
32. **Humayun**'s tomb city is **Delhi**.
33. **Jahangir**'s tomb city is **Lahore**.
34. **Shah Jahan**'s tomb city is **Agra**.
35. **Vijayanagara** (capital tradition at **Hampi**) builds large Dravida (द्रविड़) temple complexes, bazaar streets, and royal platforms remembered in the UNESCO Hampi landscape.

Chapter 13: Sculpture

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Gandhara** school uses grey **schist** and Greco-Roman / Hellenistic modelling in the north-west. It is not an Uttar Pradesh school.
2. **Mathura** (मथुरा) school uses red or spotted **sandstone**, indigenous modelling, and sits in **Uttar Pradesh**. It cuts Buddha (बुद्ध) and Tirthankara images.
3. **Amaravati** school uses **limestone** narrative panels in Andhra. It is free narrative relief more than Mathura's freestanding icons.
4. **Gupta Sarnath Buddha (सारनाथ)** shows **dharmachakra** (धर्मचक्र) mudra, a transparent robe, and spiritual calm. It differs from heavy-volume Kushan Mathura figures.
5. **Mauryan polish** is the mirror Chunar surface. Gupta finish (गुप्त) is smooth idealism, not the same mirror polish.
6. **Nataraja** holds **damaru** (डमरु) and fire, shows **abhaya** and **gajahasta**, places the right foot on **Apasmara** (अपस्मार), and stands in a **prabhamandala** (प्रभामंडल).
7. **Lion Capital** of Sarnath: four (चार) lions back to back; abacus with horse, bull, elephant, and lion plus **dharmachakra**. It became the **National Emblem** in **1950**.
8. **Bharhut** is **Shunga** (शुंग), not Mauryan. Early **Sanchi** remains largely aniconic before later iconic (साकार) additions.
9. **Khajuraho**, **Sanchi**, **Konark** (कोणार्क), Chola bronze, and **Didarganj** are outside Uttar Pradesh. Gandhara and Amaravati are also not UP schools.
10. **Chola Nataraja** is a South Indian temple processional bronze. The Indus **Dancing Girl** is a tiny lost-wax figurine from Harappa-age craft, not Shiva Nataraja.
11. **Konark** is the Ganga-period Sun chariot temple of Odisha. **Khajuraho** is the Chandela complex of Madhya Pradesh. Do not swap region or dynasty.
12. **Ahichhatra** and **Kaushambi** are the UP terracotta homes. They are craft-and-figurine centres, not Gandhara schist ateliers.
13. **Gupta** (गुप्त) sculpture is the classical ideal. Later Indian and Southeast Asian icons copy this calm type.
14. **Yaksha** images are older than the Buddha image.
15. **Udayagiri** near Vidisha (विदिशा) in Madhya Pradesh has the **Varaha** relief of Chandragupta (चंद्रगुप्त) II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय). Do not confuse it with Odisha's Udayagiri–Khandagiri (खंडगिरि) caves.
16. **Deogarh Dashavatara (दशावतार)** carries Vishnu panels on an early structural (संरचनात्मक) temple.
17. **Bharhut** is **Shunga**. Panels are labelled Jatakas. Yakshi brackets appear. It is not Mauryan.
18. **Sanchi** toranas (तोरण) carry narrative scenes and Yakshis. Early railings still avoid a human Buddha.
19. **Amaravati** and **Nagarjunakonda** (नागार्जुनकोंडा) (Ikshvaku (इक्ष्वाकु) belt) develop Andhra limestone narrative relief around the stupa.
20. **Dharmachakra mudra** (धर्मचक्र मुद्रा) turns the wheel. It marks the Sarnath sermon.
21. **Bhumisparsha mudra** is earth-witness. It marks enlightenment.
22. **Abhaya mudra** means fearlessness.
23. **Dhyana mudra** means meditation.
24. **Varada mudra** means boon-giving.
25. **Khajuraho** is **Chandela** work in Madhya Pradesh.
26. **Konark** is Eastern Ganga (गंगा) work in Odisha.
27. **Mahabalipuram** is Pallava. It is open-air granite.
28. **Brihadeeswara** (बृहदीश्वर) is a Chola granite vimana (विमान). Ritual (कर्मकाण्ड) bronzes matter more here than a crowded wall programme.
29. **Hoysala** temples at Belur (बेलूर) and Halebidu (हलेबीडु) use **soapstone** (chloritic schist). Carving is jewellery-fine. The plan is star-shaped.
30. **Ellora Kailasa (कैलास) (cave 16)** is Rashtrakuta (राष्ट्रकूट). The whole temple is cut down from living rock.
31. **Elephanta** (एलिफेंटा) holds the **Maheshamurti (महेशमूर्ति) / Trimurti (त्रिमूर्ति)** Shiva. It is not Ellora Kailasa.

32. **Gommateshwara (Bahubali)** stands at **Shravanabelagola** in Karnataka. It is a colossal Jain image in **kayotsarga. Mahamastakabhisheka** is held every **12** years.
33. **Modhera** (मोढेरा) is a Solanki Surya temple in Gujarat.
34. **Chunar sandstone** comes from the Mirzapur (मिर्ज़ापुर) belt in **Uttar Pradesh. Mauryan pillars take a** mirror polish** on it. The Lion Capital is this stone.
35. **Mathura** icons use red or spotted **sandstone**. The region is **Uttar Pradesh. The age is Kushan into Gupta.

Chapter 14: Folk (लोक) Culture

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **NHDP** and **RMSS** remain the two handloom umbrella schemes.
2. **Folk art** (लोक कला) is community, oral, and ritual (कर्मकाण्ड). It is not a Natyashastra (नाट्यशास्त्र) classical school like Bharatanatyam (भरतनाट्यम्) or a court Mughal (मुग़ल) miniature (लघु चित्र) atelier.
3. **Madhubani** (मधुबनी) belongs to Mithila in Bihar. It is bright geometric work and carries a **GI**. It is not a named UNESCO ICH element by itself.
4. **Warli** (वारली) belongs to Maharashtra. It is tribal (आदिवासी) white-on-red painting. Do not place Warli in Bihar or Uttar Pradesh.
5. **Pattachitra** (पट्टचित्र) belongs to Odisha.
6. **Phad** (फड़) belongs to Rajasthan.
7. **Gond** (गोंड) belongs to Madhya Pradesh.
8. **Kalamkari** (कलमकारी) belongs to Andhra Pradesh.
9. **Sanjhi** (सांझी) belongs to Mathura (मथुरा)–Vrindavan (वृंदावन) in Uttar Pradesh. It is paper-cutting and now carries a GI.
10. **Phulkari** (फुलकारी) belongs to Punjab.
11. **Pithora** (पिथौरा) is Rathwa wall painting of Gujarat.
12. **Saura** (सौरा) is Odisha wall-icon painting, also called *idital* (इडिटाल).
13. **Cheriyal** (चेरियल) is Telangana narrative scroll painting.
14. **Kalighat** (कालीघाट) is Kolkata patachitra watercolour of West Bengal.
15. **Rogan** (रोगन) is boiled-castor-oil fabric art of Kutch.
16. **Aipan** (ऐपण) is ritual floor and wall art of Uttarakhand (उत्तराखंड).
17. **Mandana** (मांडना) is festive chalk design of Rajasthan.
18. **Handloom** is cloth woven on a manual loom. Yarn may be mill-spun. **Khadi** (खादी) is **hand-spun and** hand-woven under **KVIC (MSME)**.
19. **Handicraft** is a handmade object such as pottery, metalwork, or embroidery. It is not the same word as handloom cloth.
20. **GI** is governed by the **1999** Act. The Registry is at **Chennai** under **DPIIT / Commerce**, not Culture and not Textiles. First Indian GI was **Darjeeling Tea (दार्जिलिंग चाय) (2004)**. Protection is about **10 years** and renewable.
21. **Banarasi** (बनारसी) brocade belongs to Varanasi (वाराणसी).
22. **Chikankari** (चिकनकारी) and **Zardozi** (ज़रदोज़ी) belong to Lucknow (लखनऊ).
23. **Bhadohi** is known for carpets. **Moradabad** is known for brass. **Firozabad** is known for glass. **Khurja** is known for pottery. **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) is known for attar.
24. **Saharanpur** is known for carved woodwork. **Agra** (आगरा) is known for marble inlay (*parchin kari*). **Pilkhuwa** is known for hand-block printing. **Nizamabad** is known for black-clay pottery.
25. **Blue Pottery** is **Jaipur**, not Lucknow. **Pushkar Fair** (पुष्कर मेला) is Rajasthan. **Surajkund** (सूरजकुंड) crafts mela is Haryana.
26. **Ramlila** (रामलीला) and **Nautanki** (नौटंकी) are Uttar Pradesh folk theatre. **Raslila** (रासलीला) is a Braj (ब्रज) folk play. It is not Manipuri (मणिपुरी) classical dance.
27. **North Central Zone Cultural Centre** is at **Prayagraj** (प्रयागराज).
28. **Sant Kabir Award** (संत कबीर) is the highest **handloom** weaver honour. **Shilp Guru** is the highest **handicraft** artisan honour. Do not swap the two.
29. **Chikankari** is Lucknow white-thread embroidery on muslin. **Zardozi** is metallic-thread court embroidery, also strong in Lucknow.
30. **Powerloom** (पावरलूम) is machine mass weave. **Handloom** is manual loom weave. Powerloom cloth is often offered as a false "handloom" option.
31. **Surajkund** is the February crafts fair of Haryana. **Pushkar Fair** is the Kartik camel fair of Rajasthan. **Pushkar Kumbh (कुंभ) 2025** (पुष्कर कुंभ) was at Mana (माना) in Uttarakhand.
32. **Banarasi Brocade** is Varanasi's premier handloom GI. **Chikankari** is Lucknow's embroidery GI.

33. **Phad** is Rajasthan scroll painting. **Pattachitra** is Odisha cloth or palm-leaf painting, sometimes also Bengal. Do not dump every scroll into Madhubani.
34. **Madhubani (Mithila)** belongs to **Bihar**. Women paint walls and paper with double line, bright fill and Kohbar marriage symbols. It has a **GI**. It is **not** a UNESCO ICH named element.
35. **Warli** belongs to **Maharashtra**. White rice-paste stick figures sit on red ochre mud. Geometry is circle, triangle and square.

Chapter 15: Cultural Heritage

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Moidams** (मोइदाम) of Charaideo, Assam, entered the World Heritage list in **2024** as India's **43rd** property.
2. **Maratha (मराठा) Military Landscapes** entered in **2025** as the **44th**. The serial covers **12** forts: eleven in Maharashtra and **Gingee** in Tamil Nadu (तमिलनाडु).
3. **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) was inscribed in **July 2026** as India's **45th** property and Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)'s **fourth**.
4. **Deepavali** (दीपावली) entered UNESCO ICH on **10 December 2025** as India's **16th** element, at 20.COM at the Red Fort (लाल किला), Delhi.
5. **Tangible** cultural heritage is a monument or site you can touch. **Intangible** cultural heritage is a living practice or skill you perform.
6. **Varanasi (वाराणसी) ghats** (वाराणसी घाट) remain on the **Tentative** List only. Do not count them as a fifth UP World Heritage Site.
7. **World Heritage Day** (18 अप्रैल) (International Day for Monuments and Sites) is celebrated on **18 April** under ICOMOS; the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage Convention was adopted (अंगीकृत) on **17 October 2003** (ratified by India in **2005**).
8. **Keoladeo** (केवलादेव) is both a natural WHS and a Ramsar wetland. Most Ramsar sites are not World Heritage Sites.
9. **Ramlila (2008)** is the UP-centred ICH performance. **Kumbh (2017)** includes Prayagraj (प्रयागराज) among the four bathing sites.
10. **Sarnath WHS** (सारनाथ) is the **2026** inscription and UP's fourth site. **Varanasi ghats** are still Tentative. Do not merge the two.
11. **Ramlila** is intangible performance heritage. The **Taj Mahal** (ताज महल) is tangible tomb heritage from **1983**. Papers love this swap.
12. **Deepavali** entered UNESCO ICH on **10 December 2025** as India's **16th** element. It is intangible festival heritage, not a monument inscription.
13. **Qutub Minar** (कुतुब मीनार) is a Delhi WHS, not an Uttar Pradesh site. **Khajuraho** is Madhya Pradesh, not UP.
14. **Immovable tangible heritage** comprises built monuments, archaeological ruins, historic (ऐतिहासिक) cities, rock-cut (शैल-कट) caves, temple complexes, and cultural landscapes.
15. **Movable tangible heritage** encompasses museum artifacts, manuscripts, numismatic collections, and protected antiquities.
16. **ASI** protects monuments under the **AMASR Act, 1958**. About **3,600+** are centrally protected. That badge is **not** a UNESCO tag.
17. **Sangeet Natak Akademi** (संगीत नाटक अकादेमी) keeps India's national ICH inventory. **IGNCA (कला केंद्र) Janapada (जनपद) Sampada** documents folk (लोक) and tribal (आदिवासी) practice.
18. **Nautanki** is UP folk theatre. It is **not** on the UNESCO list.
19. **Holi** as a generic festival is **not** listed. **Deepavaliis** listed (**2025**).
20. **ICOMOS** evaluates cultural files. **IUCN** evaluates natural files.
21. **OUV** means the site matters to all humanity, not only to one nation.
22. **Manas** (Assam) was on the Danger List and was later removed after recovery.
23. **World Heritage Day** is **18 April**. ICOMOS marks it. UPPCS has matched this date twice.
24. **Ramsar (1971)** is wetlands. **UNESCO MAB (1971)** is biosphere reserves (जैवमंडल आरक्षित क्षेत्र). Neither is a WHS tag.
25. **Keoladeo** (Rajasthan) is a rare double: natural WHS **1985** and a Ramsar site. **Sultanpur** (Haryana) is Ramsar only. **Rudrasagar** (Tripura) is Ramsar only.
26. **Nawrouz / Novruz** is a **multinational** element. Indian Parsi and other communities share it. India is not the sole owner.
27. **20.COM** met at the **Red Fort, New Delhi**, in **December 2025**. It was the first time India hosted the ICH Committee. **Deepavali** was inscribed there.
28. **UP has four** cultural WHS. The fourth is **Sarnath (2026)**. The first three are **Taj Mahal (1983)**, **Agra Fort (1983)** and **Fatehpur Sikri (1986)**.
29. **Sarnath** is a serial property: **Chaukhandi Stupa (स्तूप)** plus the archaeological remains (Dhamek (धमेख), monasteries, Lion (सिंह) Capital findspot). It is **not** the Varanasi ghats.
30. **Varanasi ghats** remain on the **Tentative List**. They are still **not** inscribed.

31. **Moidams** of Charaideo, **Assam (2024)**, are Ahom mound burials. They were India's **43rd** WHS.
32. **Maratha Military Landscapes (2025)** are **12** forts, mostly in **Maharashtra**, with **Gingee** in **Tamil Nadu**. They were the **44th**.
33. **Sarnath (2026)** is the **45th**.
34. **Santiniketan** (Birbhum, WB, **2023**) is Tagore's university town.
35. **Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (2023)** are **Belur (बेलूर), Halebidu (हलेबीडु) and Somanathapura** in Karnataka. They are not Ramappa.

Chapter 16: Archaeology (पुरातत्व)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Sarnath** (सारनाथ) was inscribed as a UNESCO World Heritage (विश्व धरोहर) site in **2026**.
2. **Archaeology** studies material remains through excavation (उत्खनन) and dating. **History** (इतिहास) builds narrative mainly from written sources. The two work together but are not the same method.
3. **Stratigraphy** (स्तरिकी) uses the law of superposition: a lower undisturbed layer is older. **Typology** (प्रकारिकी) compares artefact styles across sites.
4. **Vertical** excavation reads time sequence. **Horizontal** excavation reads one-period layout. Wheeler (व्हीलर)'s **box-grid** kept **balks** between squares.
5. **Radiocarbon (C-14 (कार्बन-14))** dates **organic** carbon only. It does not date a stone seal (मुद्रा) directly. **Thermoluminescence** (ताप-संदीप्ति) dates fired clay or brick.
6. **ASI** began in **1861** with **Alexander (सिकंदर) Cunningham** as first Director General. It sits under the Culture ministry (संस्कृति). Digging needs licence under **AMASR 1958**.
7. **Mandi** and **Hulas** are UP. **Rakhigarhi** is Haryana. That state split is a standing prelims trap.
8. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) was identified by **V. S. Wakankar (वाकणकर)** in **1957** in **Madhya Pradesh**. It is prehistoric rock shelter (शैल आश्रय) art, not a Harappan city.
9. **Sanauli** (सनौली) in **Baghpat, UP**, excavated around **2018**, is the late Harappan / OCP **chariot** site. It is not the easternmost Indus city.
10. **In-situ** (स्थान पर) conservation keeps remains on the mound. **Ex-situ** (स्थानांतरित) moves objects to a museum. Both appear in heritage management stems.
11. **BSIP Lucknow** is named for aDNA work linked to recent Rakhigarhi skeletal study. The bones themselves are from **Haryana**, not from a UP Indus city.
12. **Manda** (on the Chenab (चिनाब) in Jammu & Kashmir) marks the northern frontier of the Indus Valley (सिंधु घाटी) Civilisation, whereas **Alamgirpur** (on the Hindon in Meerut, UP) marks its easternmost frontier.
13. **Harappa** and **Mohenjo-daro** are the twin discovery cities of the 1920s. Later famous Indian sites fill the Gujarat–Rajasthan–Haryana–UP map.
14. **Kalibangan** is famous for the ploughed field and fire altars in Rajasthan. Do not place Kalibangan in Uttar Pradesh.
15. **Dholavira** is a Gujarat Harappan city with water systems and a signboard. **Lothal** is the dockyard city of Gujarat. Keep both in Gujarat, not in UP.
16. **History** reads texts. Archaeology reads layers. Both are needed after the Mauryas.
17. **Stratigraphy** follows the law of superposition. In an undisturbed trench the **lower layer is older**.
18. **Typology** dates by shape. A pot type or seal style is matched across mounds before a lab date exists.
19. **Radiocarbon (C-14)** dates **organic** carbon: charcoal, bone, wood, seed. It does **not** date a stone seal or a copper tool by itself.
20. **Thermoluminescence (TL) dating** is employed specifically to date crystalline materials subjected to heat, making it the primary method for dating ancient pottery, terracotta figurines, and fired brick.
21. **Pollen analysis** reconstructs crop and climate. It does not date a metal hoard.
22. **Epigraphy** reads inscriptions. **Numismatics** reads coins (रूपक). Both are archaeological source-types, not separate ministries.
23. **ASI** was set up in **1861. Alexander Cunningham** was the first Director General. It sits under **Culture**.
24. **GPR** and **LiDAR** map buried walls before a spade goes in.
25. **Narmada (नर्मदा) / Hathnora** yielded a hominin fossil. **Arun Sonakia (1982)** is the named finder. It is palaeoanthropology, not an IVC (नगरीय) city.
26. **Daya Ram Sahni** opened **Harappa in 1921**. Do not give him Mohenjo-daro.
27. **R. D. Banerji** opened **Mohenjo-daro in 1922**. Do not give him Harappa.
28. **John Marshall** announced the Indus civilisation to the world in **1924**. Large ASI clearance at Mohenjo-daro ran into **1931**.
29. **Mortimer Wheeler** re-dug **Harappa in 1946** with a measured grid. He is not the first IVC excavator.

30. **Mehrgarh** (मेहरगढ़) in Balochistan is the Neolithic farming precursor. It is not an Indian state site.
31. **Bruce Foote** found India's first palaeolith at **Pallavaram (1863)**.
32. **James Prinsep** deciphered **Brahmi (ब्राह्मी) in 1837**. That unlocked Ashokan edicts. It is epigraphy, not an IVC dig.
33. **Ajanta** (अजंता) was rediscovered in **1819** by **John Smith (स्मिथ)**, a British officer.
34. **Nalanda** (नालंदा) was noted by early surveyors. ASI clearance in the twentieth century exposed the mahavihara (महाविहार). UNESCO WHS (यूनेस्को) year is **2016**.
35. **S. R. Rao** is the Lothal and later Dwarka name.

Chapter 17: Essentials: Awards, Personalities & GI Tags

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Jnanpith** (ज्ञानपीठ) is given by the **Bharatiya Jnanpith** trust from **1965** (first winner **G. Sankara Kurup**). It is **not** a Sahitya Akademi award (साहित्य अकादेमी). The **58th** Jnanpith went to **Rambhadracharya** (with Gulzar).
2. **Sahitya Yuva Puraskar** (युवा पुरस्कार) is for young authors ≤35. **Bismillah Khan Yuva** is SNA's young **performing** award. Do not swap the two Yuva names.
3. **GI** follows the **1999** Act. Registry is at **Chennai** under **DPIIT / Commerce**, not Culture. First Indian GI was **Darjeeling Tea (दार्जिलिंग टी) (2004)**. Protection is about **10 years** and renewable.
4. **Bismillah Khan** is the shehnai (शहनाई) maestro of **Varanasi** (वाराणसी), Bharat Ratna **2001**, and namesake of SNA Yuva. **Birju Maharaj** is Lucknow Kathak (कथक) and not Bharat Ratna.
5. **M. S. Subbulakshmi** is the first musician Bharat Ratna (**1998**, Carnatic (कर्नाटक)). **Lata Mangeshkar** is the playback Bharat Ratna of **2001**.
6. **Bharat Ratna** is the highest civilian honour; the Prime Minister recommends names to the President. It is not an akademi prize.
7. **Ustad Zakir Hussain** (tabla) held Padma awards and Grammys but was **not** Bharat Ratna; he died in **December 2024**.
8. **Sant Kabir Award** is the highest handloom weaver honour (Textiles). **Shilp Guru** is the highest handicraft artisan honour. Do not swap them with akademi prizes.
9. **M. S. Subbulakshmi** received it in **1998**. She is the **first musician** Bharat Ratna. The form is Carnatic vocal.
10. **Pandit Ravi Shankar** received it in **1999**. The instrument is **sitar**.
11. **Lata Mangeshkar** and **Ustad Bismillah Khan** received it together in **2001**.
12. **Pandit Bhimsen Joshi** received it in **2008**. The form is Hindustani (हिंदुस्तानी) khayal (ख्याल) (Kirana (किराना)).
13. **Bhupen Hazarika** received it in **2019** (posthumous). Assamese music and film.
14. **Pandit Jasraj** received it in **2020** (posthumous). Mewati vocal.
15. **Satyajit Ray** received the Bharat Ratna in **1992** for his monumental contributions to world cinema (not as a musical vocalist).
16. **Dr Zakir Husain** (Bharat Ratna **1963**) was the educationist who became President. **Ustad Zakir Hussain** the tabla maestro is **not** a Bharat Ratna.
17. **Pandit Birju Maharaj** is Padma Vibhushan and SNA Ratna. He is **not** Bharat Ratna.
18. **Rabindranath Tagore won the** Nobel Prize in 1913**. He died in** 1941**, before Bharat Ratna existed.
19. **Akademi Ratna (Fellowship)** is the highest SNA honour. Living Fellows are capped near **40** (raised from 30). It is **not** a five-person club.
20. **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar** is SNA's youth performing-arts prize. It is **not** Sahitya Yuva Puraskar.
21. **Rukmini Devi Arundale** is an SNA Ratna-level Bharatanatyam (भरतनाट्यम्) name.
22. **Birju Maharaj** is an SNA Ratna-level Kathak name.
23. **Balasaraswati** is an SNA Ratna-level Bharatanatyam name.
24. **Kelucharan Mohapatra** is an SNA Ratna-level Odissi (ओडिसी) name.
25. **Ebrahim Alkazi** is an SNA Ratna-level theatre-direction name.
26. **Triennale India** is LKA's international exhibition. NGMA does not run it.
27. **NGMA** is a **gallery** of modern art (Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru). Lalit Kala is an **academy**.
28. **Fellowship (Akademi Ratna)** is the highest Sahitya honour.
29. **Yuva Puraskar** is for authors aged **35 or below** on the relevant date.
30. **Bal Sahitya Puraskar** is children's literature.
31. **Bhojpuri** is **not** a separate Sahitya Akademi recognised language.
32. **Jnanpith** is **not** a Sahitya Akademi prize. The trust is **Bharatiya Jnanpith**. The first award was **1965** (**G. Sankara Kurup**, Malayalam).
33. **Banarasi Brocade** is a Varanasi GI.

34. **Chikankari** (चिकनकारी) is a Lucknow GI.

35. **Bhadohi carpet** is a UP GI.